



Basic Qualification Course II (BQC II) Resource Guide

U.S. Coast Guard Auxiliary
Training Directorate
December 2023



Executive Summary

Auxiliary Members who are familiar with the customs, traditions and history of the Coast Guard Auxiliary, understand our Missions and Programs, the organizational structure, the policies and regulations that guide us, and understand the protocols and proper uniform wear will be far better prepared to serve the Coast Guard than less knowledgeable Members. All this information is contained in the Auxiliary Manual (AUXMAN) located here:

<https://wow.uscgaux.info/content.php?unit=H-DEPT&category=auxiliary-manuals>

It is this manual you would go to for specific information on virtually all aspects of the Auxiliary. But, just as you wouldn't read a dictionary to learn a language, you wouldn't read the AUXMAN to learn about the auxiliary. The BQC II is a method of getting the basic information you need as an Auxiliarist that is easily reviewable, understandable, and reasonable in complexity.

With this in mind, the BQC II has broken the AUXMAN into 7 independent modules with each model related to one or two chapters. They have been developed to allow for self-paced study which will ensure that you have the necessary tools to navigate your way through the core concepts of becoming a competent and valuable member of the U.S. Coast Guard Auxiliary. At the end of each module there is a 20 question open book quiz, requiring a 90% to pass. The results of each exam will sync with AUXDATA. You will receive a certificate of completion upon passing all 7 of the quizzes. Each module should take about an hour to watch the video lecture and study corresponding materials.

Module Goals

The goals of the seven Module units are to provide you with a basic level of knowledge upon which you can build your volunteer "career" in the Auxiliary and effectively work with active duty members of the Coast Guard. Each module corresponds to specific chapters in the AUXMAN. Upon completion of all seven modules, you will have a strong basis of knowledge about the key aspects of working with the Coast Guard as an Auxiliarist. The modules include:

- Module 1: History, Purpose and Administration (Ch.1);
Missions and Programs (Ch. 2)
- Module 2: Membership (Ch.3); Auxiliary Organizational Structure (Ch. 4)
- Module 3: Member Training and Qualifications (Ch.8); Uniforms (Ch. 10)
- Module 4: Human Resources (Ch. 7);
Auxiliarist Recognition and Awards (Ch. 11)
- Module 5: Regulations and Policies (Ch. 5)
- Module 6: Support and Basic Materials (Ch.6);
Reimbursement of Auxiliarists (Ch.9)
- Module 7: Guide to Customs, Courtesy, and Protocol for Auxiliary Units
and Auxiliarists (Ch. 12)

History, Purpose, and Administration

Congress established the Revenue Cutter Service on August 4, 1790 (the “Coast Guard’s Birthday”).

The Father of the Coast Guard is Alexander Hamilton. Congress passed Alexander Hamilton’s Revenue Cutter Bill, which provided for the construction of ten armed cutters to protect and ensure revenue collection.

President George Washington commissioned Hopley Yeaton as the first officer of the Revenue Cutter Service.

Ten cutters were ordered at \$1,000 each.

Captain Williams of USRC Massachusetts ordered special modifications from the builder that made his cutter the largest and most expensive, at approximately \$2,000.

The Coast Guard at a Glance

Throughout the years...

- Merged with the “Life Saving Service” to become the “United States Coast Guard” in 1915.
- Congress established the Auxiliary in 1939.
- The Auxiliary’s missions were dramatically expanded in 1996 and through the post-9/11 years.

Today...

- Nation’s oldest continual sea going service, now a part of the Department of Homeland Security.
- Assigned 11 missions by statute, accomplished through a strategy of Prevention and Response
- Approximately 21,000 Auxiliary, 40,000 active duty, 7,000 reservists, and 8,000 civilian personnel.

Pioneering Coast Guardsmen

David Jarvis

- Officer aboard USRC Bear;
- Led Bear crew and reindeer in 1500-mile rescue of 8 whaling crews at Barrow's Point, AK;
- Awarded the Congressional Gold Medal for this service.

Joshua James

- Saved 600 lives, with his first rescue at 15 years old;
- Awarded Gold Lifesaving Medal for his extraordinary service in The Hurricane of 1888.
- Required a special act of Congress to remain on active duty, where he died at age 74.

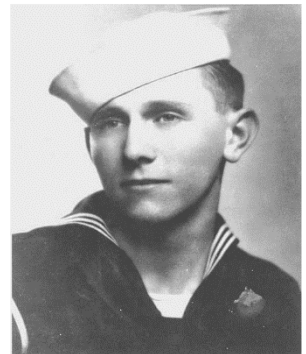
Elmer Stone

- Recognized as the “Father of Coast Guard Aviation”, developed the Coast Guard's aviation programs and modern air-sea rescue;
- Co-pilot on history's first trans-Atlantic airplane flight, was awarded the Navy Cross and Congressional Medal of Achievement;
- Developed early carrier catapult and arresting gear, technology still used today.



Douglas Munro

- On September 27, 1942 at Point Cruz on Guadalcanal, Signalman First Class Munro led the rescue of a detachment of Marines under attack trapped on the beach;
- Using his vessel as a shield from the enemy, four other Higgins boats loaded the Marines;
- Munro, fatally wounded, was awarded the Medal of Honor and is the only recipient of this award in service of the Coast Guard.



Michael Healy

- First man of African-American descent to command a ship of the United States government;
- Commanded USRC Bear and introduced reindeer in Alaska;
- Recognized in 1885 by Congress for humanitarian and life-saving work;
- The modern icebreaker, CGC Healy, was named in his honor.



Ida Lewis

- Operated Lime Rock Light from age 14 through 64 in addition to being a caretaker for her family;
- Act of Congress made her the light's Keeper in 1879;
- Credited saving 18 lives (perhaps as many as 237), the earliest at age 12 and last at age 63;
- Forbearer to heritage of women in the Coast Guard and inspiration to the women's suffrage movement.



Coast Guard Ethos

The Coast Guard Ethos guides the mission and vision of the Coast Guard.

In Service to our Nation
With Honor, Respect, and Devotion to Duty
We protect
We defend
We save
We are Semper Paratus
We are the United States Coast Guard



Coast Guard Core Values

Honor

Integrity is our standard. We demonstrate uncompromising ethical conduct and moral behavior in all our actions. We are loyal and accountable to the public trust.



Respect

We value our diverse workforce. We treat each other and those we serve with fairness, dignity, and compassion. We encourage creativity through empowerment. We work as a team.



Devotion to Duty

We are professionals, military and civilian, who seek responsibility, accept accountability, and are committed to the successful achievement of our organizational goals. We exist to serve. We serve with pride.



When did the United States Coast Guard Auxiliary Begin?

On June 23, 1939, Congress established a U. S. Coast Guard Non-Military Reserve, comprised of unpaid, volunteer U.S. citizens who owned motorboats or yachts. The United States' entry into the war in Europe and Asia created a high priority for manpower.

In 1941 Congress created a separate Military Reserve and renamed the original Non-Military volunteer Reserve as the U.S. Coast Guard Auxiliary.

What is the Purpose of the USCG Auxiliary?

14 U.S.C. §3902 states the purpose of the Auxiliary:

“The purpose of the Auxiliary is to assist the Coast Guard as authorized by the Commandant in performing any Coast Guard function, power, duty, role, mission or operation authorized by law.”

These roles and responsibilities of the Auxiliary allow many civil duties formerly performed only by the Coast Guard to be shared or transferred to the Auxiliary.

What is the Role of the Auxiliary?

The Coast Guard is a military service and is a component of the six U.S. Armed Forces.

The Coast Guard Auxiliary is a component of Coast Guard Forces and is under the general organizational umbrella of the Coast Guard, as are the active duty, reserve, and civilian components.

The Auxiliary is non-military and takes part in no law enforcement or combat missions that are assigned to the Coast Guard.

Auxiliarists are specifically directed by the Commandant to perform the civil missions. Auxiliarists are not contractually bound, enlisted, or commissioned officers, but are volunteers pledged to serve in the Coast Guard Auxiliary.

How is the Auxiliary's Role Defined?

The Commandant's administrative authority defines the Auxiliary's role. The Commandant determines how the Auxiliary may assist in performing Coast Guard civil missions. The Commandant also determines how the Auxiliary may assist the Coast Guard by prescribing training and qualifications necessary to provide this assistance and to perform such activities.

The Commandant and the Auxiliary

The overall authority for Auxiliary administration rests with the Commandant of the Coast Guard (CCG). The responsibilities of the Commandant are to effectively plan, coordinate, and carry out the Auxiliary's missions. The Commandant's direct representative in all Coast Guard matters within a Coast Guard district is the District Commander, and is the senior Coast Guard officer in the Coast Guard district.

The District Commander and the Auxiliary

The District Commander's responsibilities include the efficient, safe, and economical performance of Coast Guard duties and the proper use of assigned personnel and facilities.

Each District has a Director of Auxiliary (DIRAUX) that works together with the Auxiliary District Commodore (DCO). The responsibilities of the DIRAUX include administering, coordinating, facilitating, supporting, advocating, advancing, and overall execution of the Auxiliary program.

The National Commodore of the Coast Guard Auxiliary

The National Commodore (NACO) is the senior and principal officer of the Auxiliary. The NACO functions to support the Commandant's strategic goals and objectives.

The NACO represents the Auxiliary and reports to the Vice Commandant of the United States Coast Guard. Additionally, the NACO represents the Auxiliary with all Coast Guard Flag officers and equivalent civilians at Coast Guard Headquarters.

Leadership Development

Leadership is essential to the success of the Auxiliary.

As you begin your Coast Guard Auxiliary career, consider creating an Individual Development Plan (IDP) with your mentor. The IDP measures leadership development progress and establishes goals for the future. More information can be found here: <https://wow.uscgaux.info/content.php?unit=AUX60&category=individual-development-plan>.

Seek to enroll in the Auxiliary leadership courses via C-Schools and complete the Leadership Competencies. More information about the leadership development programs can be found at: <https://wow.uscgaux.info/content.php?unit=AUX60>.

Leadership Development Framework

The Commandant has established the Leadership Development Framework for the entire Coast Guard (COAUXMTINST 5351.3). The Framework outlines 28 leadership competencies, cross-referenced with 5 levels of responsibility, along with a description of expertise and level of performance expected in each competency at each level.

Use it as a guide as you develop your leadership skills and experience within the Auxiliary, particularly as you consider serving in positions of increasingly responsibility.

Leadership Responsibility Levels

Performance Level	Attendant Responsibilities	Auxiliary
Executive	The highest-level policy and decision makers within the Chain of Leadership.	COMO
Senior Manager	Officials with programmatic or command responsibilities including overall supervision of an organization or unit.	DCOS, DCAPT, DDC, DSO, DIR
Mid-Level Manager	Managers of first-line supervisors, such as department heads, executive officers, executive petty officers, or division chiefs.	DVC, DCDR, VCDR, BC, ADSO, BA, SO
First-Line Supervisor	Supervision of others with responsibility for the accomplishment of specific tasks.	FC, VFC, FSO
Worker	No significant supervisory duties.	Member
The full table is provided in the Leadership Development Framework; responsibility levels for Enlisted, Officers, and Civilian Employees are also provided alongside the levels for Auxiliarists shown here in column three above.		

Appendix B in the New Member Reference Guide contains acronyms including Auxiliary Officer abbreviations.

Chain of Leadership

Auxiliary leaders responsible for unit administration and supervision are elected at each level. These elected Auxiliary leaders in turn appoint appropriate staff officers to carry out Auxiliary missions and programs. “Chain of Leadership and Management” is a:

- System of organizational communication and responsibility;
- Provides for an effective and efficient path for the flow of information through all organizational levels; and
- Best described as a chain of leadership and management rather than a chain of command, as no military command authority exists.

Auxiliarists must utilize the chain of leadership and management in communicating ideas, information, and requests to the appropriate leader. This process is important for the orderly conduct of organizational activities and is proven to actually speed work results, since many solutions are found directly at the flotilla or division leadership level.

What is an Elected Leader?

The Auxiliary elects leaders. At the flotilla level there is the Flotilla Commander (FC) and Vice Flotilla Commander (VFC.) Candidates for this office must have been in the Auxiliary for at least a year, must have completed the Core Training courses, and must have completed the Administrative Procedures Course (APC) or Flotilla Leadership Course (FLC) exams.

At the Division level there is an elected Division Commander (DCDR) and an elected Division Vice Commander (VCDR).

At the District level is the District Commodore (DCO), District Chief of Staff (DCOS), and District Captains (DCAPT).

What is an Appointed Leader?

Auxiliary members may be designated as program managers. These program managers are appointed by the unit leader, and are called staff officers (FSO, SO, DSO).

Staff officers must communicate with their counterpart members at the next higher or lower organizational level using a system known as “Parallel Staffing”.

Parallel Staffing is a two-way process by which District Staff Officers, Division Staff Officers, and Flotilla Staff Officers pass information to each other about specific programs.

Active Duty, Reserve Coast Guard or Auxiliary Member?

Often the public does not understand the difference between Coast Guard active duty and the Auxiliary, especially when the uniform is worn. Coast Guard active duty members are bound by strict military grooming and weight standards.

As a matter of pride, all Auxiliary members should set the goal to strive to attain the same standards as active duty members. Auxiliary members who wear the Auxiliary uniform will be held to high grooming and appearance standards.

Missions and Programs

The Commandant has assigned primary responsibility for the accomplishment of certain missions to the Auxiliary as an organization.

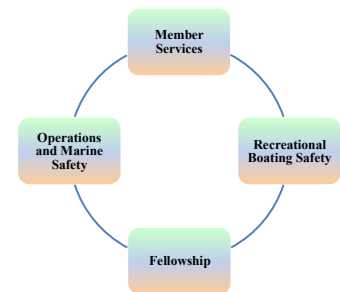
The missions assigned to the Auxiliary and the mission areas authorized for individual Auxiliarist participation are essential and basic to operating the Auxiliary and effectively using Auxiliarists to successfully support and accomplish the missions of the Coast Guard.

With passage of the Coast Guard Authorization Act in October 1996, the Auxiliary's role was greatly expanded to enable Auxiliary participation in any Coast Guard mission authorized by the Commandant. In general, this law opens all Coast Guard mission areas to the Auxiliary, *with the exception of* combat and direct law enforcement.

The Four Cornerstones

The four cornerstones are defined as follows:

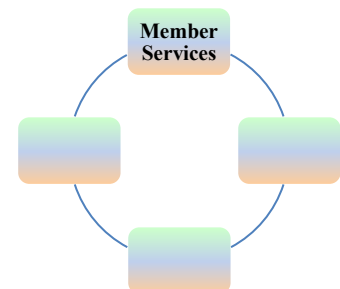
- Member Services
- Recreational Boating Safety
- Operations and Marine Safety
- Fellowship



Member Services

The first and primary mission of the Auxiliary is to attract, recruit, develop, train, nurture, and retain Auxiliarists for assignment to duty. Auxiliarists provide support in several personnel and administrative management areas as follows:

- Finance Staff (FN)
- Information Services (IS)
- Communications Services (CS)
- Materials (MA)
- Human Resources (HR)
- Member Training (MT)
- Legal/Parliamentarian (LP)
- Public Affairs (PA)
- Publications (PB)
- Secretary/Records (SR)

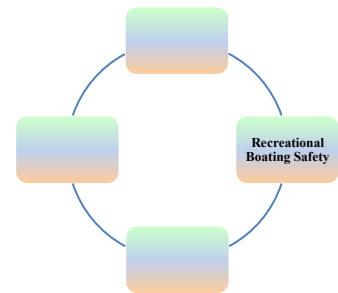


Recreational Boating Safety (RBS)

The Auxiliary has mission responsibility to support Boating Safety with the development and implementation of various programs to improve the knowledge, safety skills, and operating environment of recreational boaters.

These programs include, but are not limited to:

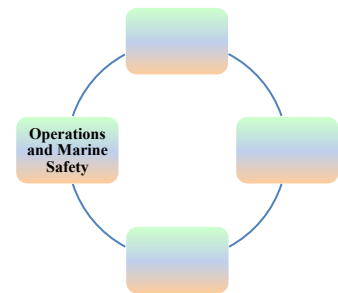
- Public Education (PE)
- Vessel Examinations (VE)
- Recreational Boating Safety (RBS) Visitation Program (RBSVP)



Operations and Marine Safety

The Auxiliary has general mission responsibility for providing resources, personnel, and facilities in support of the operations and marine safety, security, and environmental protection missions, and in support of other Coast Guard missions, when requested. These include, but are not limited to:

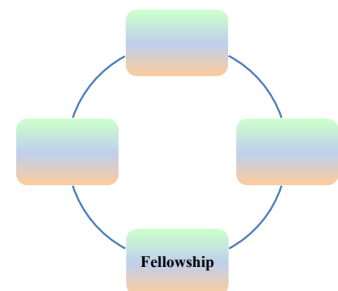
- Operations (OP)
- Aviation (AV)
- Communications (CM)
- Marine Safety (MS)
- Navigation Systems (NS)



Fellowship

The Coast Guard recognizes the importance of this aspect of volunteer participation and encourages a close relationship between Auxiliarists and other Coast Guard personnel.

Fellowship makes the team work, and binds the entire organization together.



Programs and Activities Authorized for Auxiliarists

Academy Admissions Partner Program (AAPP)
Administrative Support to Units
Auxiliary Culinary Service Program (AUXCS)
Bridge Program
Civil Air Patrol Support
Coast Guard Unit Support
Contingency Preparedness
Health Care Services Assistance
Language Interpreters
Legislative Liaison Committee
Licensing of Merchant Mariners
Marine Safety, Security, and Environmental Protection
Maritime Domain Awareness
Media Events
Multi-Mission Harbor Safety
National Safe Boating Week
Navigation Systems
Operational Support
Other Commandant Authorized Programs
Participation
Port Safety and Security
Public Affairs Support
Public Education
Recreational Boating Safety
Recreational Boating Safety Visitation Program
Recruiting
Search and Rescue
State Liaison Officer Program
Vessel Inspections/Examinations
Waterways Management

In the event of a funding hiatus, activities that are not authorized by law to provide for national security or protect life and property will be suspended. In general, no Auxiliary Activities are considered exempt, and should therefore cease unless otherwise directed by written orders from a Coast Guard issuing authority. Announcements regarding changes and guidance will normally be issued via an ALCOAST (all Coast Guard) message.

Membership

Membership in the Coast Guard Auxiliary is not a constitutionally protected liberty or property interest. Nor is it an entitlement due to the meeting of basic membership eligibility criteria, namely citizenship, age, skill, and desire. Further, the scope of membership depends upon the determination of suitability for service stemming from requisite Personnel Security Investigations (PSI).

Auxiliary membership may reasonably be expected to be granted and sustained only provided an individual meets basic eligibility and suitability for service criteria in addition to demonstrated and consistent adherence to the principles encapsulated in the New Member Pledge.

Membership hinges upon the demonstrated commitment to and practice of the Coast Guard's core values: Honor, Respect, and Devotion to Duty. These considerations are significant in the context and application of administrative discipline.

Who is Eligible to Join the Auxiliary?

Auxiliary membership is open to:

- All U.S. citizens or those of dual citizenship.
- Those seventeen years of age or older.
- Current military active duty or reserve personnel or veterans who were discharged under honorable conditions.

Membership is fully achieved:

- After successful completion of the Auxiliary enrollment application (including the passing of the New Member Exam), and
- Receipt of a favorable (FAV) PSI

Facility (vessel, aircraft, or radio station) ownership and special skills are desirable, but not mandatory for membership.

Physical Fitness Requirements

There are no specific physical standards that must be met in order to be eligible to enroll in the Auxiliary. To become certified in an operational discipline, Auxiliarists must demonstrate ability, mobility, and endurance to satisfactorily complete performance-based training and qualification tasks.

Once certified, Auxiliarists must meet currency maintenance requirements to validate continued eligibility. Auxiliarists are charged with the responsibility to use good judgment and common sense when evaluating their continuing ability to carry out assignments to duty.

PSI Overview

The Auxiliary PSI program was established as a requirement to assess the suitability of individuals for Auxiliary membership (not to grant security clearances).

There are three types of Auxiliary PSIs:

- Operational Support (OS) – applicable for entry level membership and most activities
- Direct Informational (DI) – applicable for Auxiliarists who require access to Coast Guard Standard Work Stations (SWS) or networks.
- Direct Operational (DO) – applicable for more advanced and mission-sensitive activities that effectively require an Auxiliarist to be security clearance-ready.

Initial Enrollment Process

The Director of Auxiliary is responsible for approving Auxiliary enrollments. Upon meeting all enrollment eligibility criteria, the Director will enter the person in AUXDATA in Approval Pending (AP) status.

A unique Member Identification Number is then assigned.

Upon receiving a Favorable PSI, the Auxiliarist will change from AP status to Basically Qualified (BQ) or AUXOP (AX) status.

Transfers

An Auxiliarist may join any flotilla or request transfer to another flotilla within the region at any time. The request shall be submitted on the Member Transfer Request Form (ANSC-7056) to the Director, via the Auxiliarist's FC, and endorsed by the FC of the prospective flotilla.

Between regions, an Auxiliarist should, but is not required to, request transfer between regions upon a change in permanent residence from one region to another using the 7056 form.

Record Retention and Handling

Records copies of any records of any disciplinary action taken with regard to an Auxiliarist shall be retained by the Director for up to three years from the date of the action.

These records shall be removed from an Auxiliarist's service record if no subsequent disciplinary action has been initiated or finalized during the specified period of time.

These records shall be placed in a separate permanent file, independent of the Auxiliarist's service record, retained by the Director for the sole purpose of documenting prior disciplinary action should the need arise.

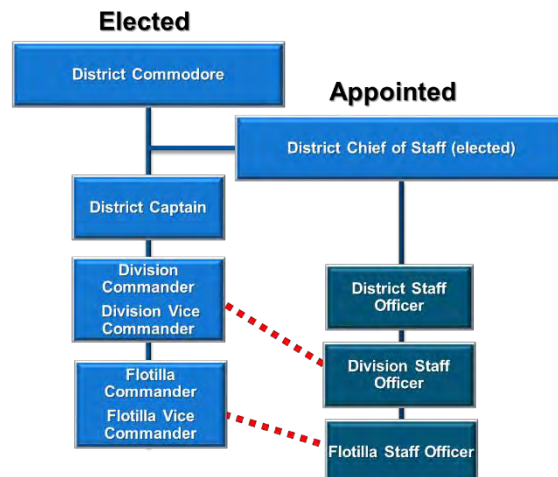
Auxiliary Organizational Structure

Basic Organization of the Auxiliary

• National	• Service-wide policy and programmatic direction • Comprised of 16 Auxiliary Districts (9 USCG Districts)
• District/Region	• Regional (multi-state) missions coordination & support • Comprised of several Sectors
• Division	• Coordinates mission execution among Flotillas • Comprised of several Flotillas in a geographic area
• Flotilla	• Foundational Auxiliary unit • Where the mission is executed

Basic Organization of the Flotilla, Division, & District Chain of Leadership

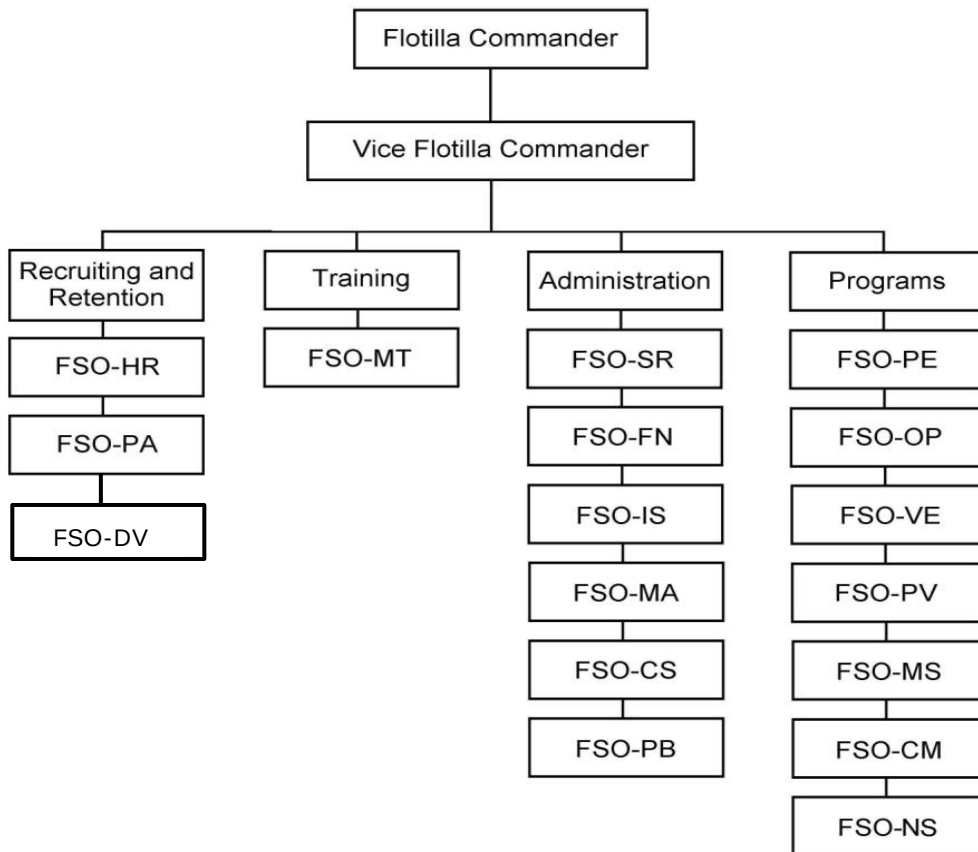
The basic structure is to have two elected leaders and several appointed staff officers in each group. They are formed into two reporting structures – the leadership (elected) and the staff (appointed) operating in parallel. The elected officers are the Commanders and the Vice Commanders for each unit. The combined district organization follows the chain of leadership shown below:



Structure of the Flotilla

The flotilla level is the basic Auxiliary organizational unit and the working level that translates programs into action. Each flotilla is led and managed by a Flotilla Commander (FC). All Auxiliarists must be members of a flotilla. See the diagram below for the full flotilla organization.

A flotilla does not have to fill all these positions, but it should at least fill the offices of FSO-SR, FN, HR, MT and at least one Program (e.g., OP, VE, IT). In some cases, the IS position is filled at the division level. The FSO-HR position defaults to the FC if not otherwise filled. Much more detail is provided in the Flotilla Procedures Manual.



Structure of the Division and District

The Division and District organization mirrors the flotilla organization with the same positions shown above. In this case the staff is referred to as SO e.g. SO-PE for Divisions and DSO e.g. DSO-PE for District level staff. In addition, the District has District Directorate Chiefs and District Captains as seen in the chain-of-leadership diagram above. District Directorate Chiefs are usually appointed for Logistics, Prevention, and Response and report to the DCOS.

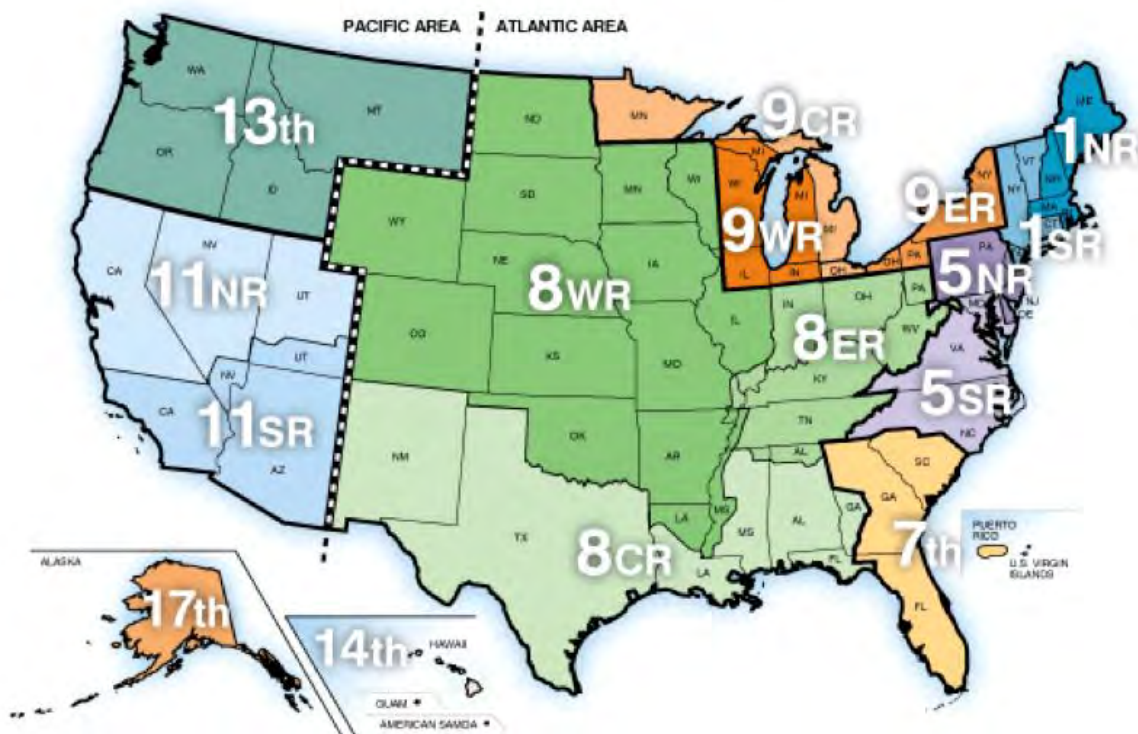
National Structure

For National administration, the Auxiliary is divided into the following three geographic areas:

- Atlantic (East) – Districts 1 N/S, 5 N/S, and 7
- Atlantic (West) – Districts 8 WR/E/C and 9 E/W/C
- Pacific – Districts 11 N/S, 13, 14 and 17

A Deputy National Commodore (DNACO) represents each Auxiliary area on the National Executive Committee (NEXCOM).

Coast Guard and Coast Guard Auxiliary Districts and Regions



National Organization Chart

The national organization chart is available at:

https://auxofficer.cgaux.org/auxoff/orgcharts/Org_Chart_National_Incumbents.pdf.

The reporting structure is as follows:

- 17 Directorates perform the program functions of the National Organization.
- Each Directorate reports to an Assistant National Commodore (ANACO) who will have responsibility for several Directorates.
- Deputy National Commodores (DNACOs) have some combination of ANACOs and District Commodores (DCOs) reporting to them.
- The VNACO (Vice National Commodore) has the DNACOs as well as the ANACOs of Legal and Diversity reporting directly to them.
- The VNACO reports directly to the National Commodore (NACO) who is the top executive of the Coast Guard Auxiliary.
- The national level of administration contains the National Executive Committee (NEXCOM) presided over by the NACO and composed of the Chief Director, the Immediate Past National Commodore (NIPCO), VNACO, and the four DNACOs.

What is an Auxiliary District?

A Coast Guard District is a geographical subdivision of an Area of the Coast Guard.

The Coast Guard is divided into two Areas, Atlantic and Pacific. Each Area is divided into Districts. There are five Districts in the Atlantic Area (1, 5, 7, 8, and 9), and four Districts in the Pacific Area (11, 13, 14, 17).

The Auxiliary Areas are divided into Districts and Regions. Atlantic Area East has five Districts/Regions (D1-NR/SR, D5-NR/SR, D7), Atlantic Area (West) has six Districts/Regions (D8-CR/ER/WR, D9-CR/ER/WR), and Pacific Area has five Districts/Regions (D11-NR/SR, D13, D14, D17). Each Auxiliary District or Region is divided into Auxiliary Divisions. Each Auxiliary Division is comprised of basic units called Flotillas.

Supervisory Administration and Duties of Boards and Committees

The division, district, and national levels each have administrative boards. A majority of the members of any board must be present to transact business. Board meetings are normally open and all Auxiliarists are welcome and invited to attend national or their district, division, and flotilla meetings. In rare situations, a closed meeting may be needed. This action will be taken only when authorized by a Director or the Chief Director for National Board meetings.

District Board duties include implementation of established Coast Guard and Auxiliary policy within the district. The Board helps the DCO to develop and carry out district policy. The Board also recommends changes in national policy to the National Board. When appropriate, the District Board guides, directs, and supervises units. The division organization exists to support the flotillas by providing administrative, training support and supervision. These actions are administered by the Division Board.

Standing Rules

Standardized standing rules are required for all Auxiliary units. All Auxiliary unit standing rules have been standardized, developed, and approved by the National Board.

At the national, district, and division levels, all standardized standing rules, with options selected, must be affirmed by two-thirds majority vote of the Auxiliary unit governing body.

The unit governing body at the national level is the National Board. At the district level it is the District Board. At the division level it is the Division Board.

Elections

Flotillas and divisions hold annual elections, as do districts, except that District Commodores and Chiefs of Staff are elected for a two year period. At the national level, elections are conducted biannually.

Appendix C of the Auxiliary Manual defines an Auxiliarist's eligibility for election, the terms of office, who votes in the elections, and when elections are held for specific offices. Eligibility shall be determined by a nominating committee that is designated by the Auxiliary unit for which the election is held.

The Director may waive any and all prerequisites and eligibility criteria for regional elections, as appropriate and with all due consideration for regional needs, circumstances, and potential impacts, including if eligible Auxiliarists are unavailable or unwilling to seek elected office.

Newly elected Auxiliary leaders, except at the national level, assume office on 1 January of the year following their election.

National elected leaders take office on 1 November of the year of their election and their term runs for two years until 31 October.

For those leaders elected in an interim election to fill a vacancy, their term begins upon election and approval (where appropriate) by the Director.

Administrative Discipline

Auxiliary administrative discipline is meant to:

- Correct inappropriate behavior
- Maintain good order throughout the organization
- Be conducted at the lowest Auxiliary organizational level that circumstances allow
- Be carried out by the Auxiliary organization itself to the maximum extent possible

Appeals of Disciplinary and PSI Actions

If an Auxiliarist in AP status receives an **UNFAV OS PSI** determination, then the Director may suspend any and all aspects of the membership.

This includes certifications, duties of office (elected and appointed), privileges, and membership during the adjudicative process until final determination is made.

No avenue of appeal of such suspension shall be afforded an Auxiliarist in AP status who is subject to these circumstances.

An Auxiliarist who, upon completion of the OS PSI process including adjudication, receives a final UNFAV PSI determination shall be disenrolled. **There is no avenue for appeal.**

If an Auxiliarist who possesses a FAV OS PSI (and is pursuing a DI or DO PSI) receives an **UNFAV DI or DO PSI** determination, then the Director shall limit their activities to those within the scope of OS FAV while the DI or DO PSI is adjudicated.

If a final UNFAV DI or DO PSI determination is made, then their activities shall be limited to those within the scope of OS FAV. **There is no avenue for appeal.**

Informal Disciplinary Action

Informal disciplinary action provides the structured, non-judicial course of action that an Auxiliary unit elected leader or appropriate appointed leader should follow when the determination is made that a minor violation of Coast Guard or Auxiliary policy has occurred.

Types of informal disciplinary action that may be administered include:

- Counseling session.
- Suspension of web privileges.
- Letters of Caution.

Formal Disciplinary Action

Formal disciplinary action provides the structured, non-judicial course of action that an Auxiliary unit elected leader or appropriate appointed leader should follow when the determination is made that a major violation of Coast Guard or Auxiliary policy has occurred.

Types of formal disciplinary actions that may be administered include suspension of any and all aspects of an Auxiliarist's membership, and may include:

- Suspension
- Letter of Reprimand
- Disenrollment

Temporary Suspension

The Director is authorized to place temporary suspensions in effect throughout the completion of a PSI or disciplinary proceeding. The Director shall consult with the DCO before imposition of any temporary suspension action.

If an involved Coast Guard command or program authority deems temporary suspension of an Auxiliarist is an appropriate course of action during the course of an investigation involving the Auxiliarist, then the Coast Guard command or program authority shall consult and work with the cognizant Director accordingly.

Appeals of Disciplinary and PSI Actions

Appeals may be made for both informal and formal disciplinary actions as well as **UNFAV OS PSI** prior to final determinations that lead to disenrollment.

An appeal of informal disciplinary action must be made in writing (memo or letter) within 30 days of the written date of notice of the action.

Informal disciplinary actions that do not remove privileges, but are just a warning about future behavior, are generally not subject to appeal.

An appeal of a formal disciplinary action taken by a DCO must be made in writing (memo or letter) to the appropriate DNACO within 30 days of the written date of notice of the action.

The DNACO shall conduct a complete review of the entire record of the formal disciplinary action, with appropriate Auxiliary legal counsel, and make a determination that revokes, modifies, or sustains the formal disciplinary action.

The DNACO's determination shall be final.

An appeal of formal disciplinary action taken by the Director must be made in writing (memo or letter) to the Director's supervisor within 30 days of the written date of notice of the action.

The Director's supervisor shall conduct a complete review of the entire record of the formal disciplinary action, with appropriate Coast Guard legal counsel, and make a determination that revokes, modifies, or sustains the formal disciplinary action.

The Director's supervisor's determination shall be final.

Appeal of Disenrollment

An appeal of disenrollment resulting from formal disciplinary action must be made in writing (memo or letter) to the District Commander within 30 days of the written date of notice of the disenrollment.

An appeal of disenrollment to the District Commander shall include a complete review of the entire record of either the formal disciplinary action or the PSI package, with appropriate Coast Guard legal counsel.

The District Commander shall make a determination that revokes or sustains the disenrollment.

In the case of disenrollment stemming from formal disciplinary action, the District Commander may also make independent findings of facts and conclusions that warrant a lesser form of disciplinary action than disenrollment and issue such accordingly.

If the District Commander's determination includes revocation of disenrollment and a lesser form of disciplinary action, then the Director may deduct the duration of the disenrollment period from the Auxiliarist's membership as it may apply toward any longevity awards and retirement.

The District Commander's determination shall be final.

Member Training and Qualifications

All members wishing to contribute should begin by:

- Completing this Basic Qualification Course (BQCII) and BQ requirements
- Becoming familiar with the Auxiliary Manual (AUXMAN) and its contents
- Choose a mission area, and begin training on a qualification (e.g. Boat Operations, Communications, Marine Safety, Vessel Examiner, Public Affairs Specialist)

Those interested in becoming a staff officer should:

- Complete all of the tasks above
- Begin consulting with a mentor to develop your Member Involvement Plan (MIP)
- Take the FLC or AUXLAMS course

Membership - Approval Pending (AP)

Approval Pending (AP) status is the administrative status for all Auxiliarists during the time between acceptance of their enrollment package and receipt of a Favorable PSI determination.

In accordance with the provisions of paragraph D.2 of Chapter 3 of the AUXMAN, Auxiliarists in AP status have the privilege of participating in virtually the entire range of Auxiliary training and qualification programs.

Membership - Basically Qualified (BQ)

To achieve BQ status, an Auxiliarist must have a Favorable PSI on record, take and complete the BQCII Course (including passing all quizzes with a 90% or higher), and must have successfully completed an approved boating safety course.

Auxiliarists in BQ status are authorized to:

- Participate in all Auxiliary training
- Be qualified, or certified on an interim basis, by the DIRAUX in programs that require BQ status.

Note: Auxiliarists in AP status may qualify in all competencies except coxswain, Personal Watercraft Operator (PWO), and the five aviation competencies. For those exceptions, interim certification may be granted for an Auxiliarist in AP status who meets the competency's qualification requirements as well as the requirements for BQ status. For example, an Auxiliarist in AP status may receive interim certification as a First Pilot in the aviation program if they meet the qualification requirements for the First Pilot competency, and have submitted their Direct Operational (DO) PSI package.

Operational Auxiliarist Status (AX)

The AUXOP, or “Operational Auxiliarist” program is an advanced training program available to members of the Coast Guard Auxiliary who wish to increase their practical relevance to Coast Guard missions, and better assist the Coast Guard to fulfill needed skill sets.

Under this program, Auxiliarists must successfully complete a minimum of seven credits from three categories of courses detailed in the following sections to receive the AUXOP designation:

- Core courses
- Leadership courses
- Elective credit elements

Members who successfully complete their training are authorized to wear the AUXOP device and their membership level advances from Basically Qualified (BQ) to Operational Auxiliarist (AX). Successful completion of one credit in the AUXOP program shall earn an Auxiliarist the Specialty Training ribbon.

More information about the AUXOP program can be found here:

<https://wow.uscgaux.info/content.php?unit=T-DEPT&category=auxop-courses>.

Member Training and Qualifications

The Flotilla Staff Officer for Member Training (FSO-MT) is responsible for providing training opportunities in the flotilla and for answering questions related to training. Auxiliarists can pursue training in Member Training (MT) programs to increase knowledge and skills, and to attain qualifications for participation in various Coast Guard and Auxiliary programs.

Special qualifications are available as Instructor (IT), Vessel Examiner (VE), Aids to Navigation (ATON) verifier, Program Visitor (PV), boat crew (BCCREW), coxswain (BCCOX), aircraft commander, first pilot, and co-pilot.

Auxiliary specialty courses offer advanced training in several fields. Examples of these courses include Weather, Seamanship, and Communications, which are also the core courses of the AUXOP program.

Auxiliarists may also enroll in Coast Guard Institute (CGI) correspondence courses and receive continuing education units (CEUs) from self-study paced course completions. Members of the Auxiliary are eligible to take any of the "Non-Classified" correspondence courses from the CGI.

Regular in-flotilla training sessions are fundamental to keeping Auxiliarists informed, interested, qualified, and ready to participate fully in Auxiliary activities. Training may also be held in coordination with the Division or District, including during District Conferences.

Auxiliary Courses and Test Administration in AP status

Auxiliarists in AP status are authorized to take any and all Auxiliary courses. Flotillas may provide essential course materials to Auxiliarists in AP status to facilitate learning.

Auxiliarists in AP status are authorized to take any and all end-of-course exams associated with these courses. Auxiliarists in AP status may be presented the corresponding course completion certificates in appropriate ceremonial venues upon successfully completing all course requirements.

Member Training and Qualifications - Incident Command System (FEMA Courses)

The Incident Command System provides a framework for common communications and operations to enable interoperability between agencies in the event of an emergency. Courses may be administered online by the FEMA Emergency Management Institute (EMI) and/or in person by team Coast Guard, EMI or certain local Emergency Management Agencies. New members should have already completed two FEMA Incident Command courses: ICS 100 – Introduction to the Incident Management System and ICS 700 – Introduction to the National Incident Management System during onboarding.

For further information, the FEMA website is: <http://training.fema.gov/IS/NIMS.aspx>.

Boat Crew Program

There are three qualifications in the boat crew program, under oversight of the Response Directorate:

- Crew Member
- Coxswain
- Personal Watercraft Operator

Auxiliarists wishing to participate in authorized Auxiliary surface operations must meet the BQ status requirement of having successfully completed an authorized boating safety course. This means that members in AP status may train and qualify as boat crewmembers, provided they have successfully completed that BQ status requirement and all other qualification requirements described in the below references. They may be granted interim certification as coxswain and Personal Watercraft Operator (PWO) given the same completions until their favorable background check is received. Specific qualification requirements can be found in:

- Auxiliary Boat Crew Training Manual
COMDTINST M16794.51 (series)
- Auxiliary Boat Crew Qualification Guide, Volume I: Crew Member
COMDTINST M16794.52 (series)
- Auxiliary Boat Crew Qualification Guide, Volume II: Coxswain
COMDTINST M16794.53 (series)
- Auxiliary Boat Crew Qualification Guide, Volume III: PWC Operator
COMDTINST M16794.54 (series)

Air Operations (AUXAIR)

Auxiliarists wishing to participate in authorized Auxiliary air operations must meet the BQ status requirement of having successfully completed an authorized boating safety course. This means that members in AP status may train and be granted interim certification in any of the five competencies described below provided they have successfully completed that BQ status requirement and all other qualification requirements described in the Auxiliary Operations Policy Manual.

The Auxiliary Operations Policy Manual, COMDTINST M16798.3 (series), provides the specific requirements and is the principal document for the Auxiliary Aviation program.

There are five levels of qualification in air operations program:

- Aircraft Commander
- First Pilot
- Co-Pilot
- Air Crew Member
- Air Observer

Other Operational Training Programs

Additional opportunities for training and duty are available depending upon specific Coast Guard needs. Training programs are available for other Auxiliary operational programs:

- Qualified watchstanding at Coast Guard active duty units.
- ATON verification and repair.
- Commercial fishing vessel safety examinations (CFVSE).
- Augmentation of Coast Guard boats and cutters.
- Augmentation of Coast Guard aircraft.

Non-Operational and Administrative Programs

Other training programs that lead to specific qualifications are available for those Auxiliarists wishing to take part in other Auxiliary non-operations and administrative programs. Certain programs (such as Dockwalker) are administered by state or local agencies with Auxiliary (non-exclusive) participation.

- Dockwalker
- Assistant Contingency Planner (AUX-ACP)
- Assistant Federal On-Scene Coordinator Representative (AUX-ET)
- Assistant License and Document Evaluator (AUX-LDEV)
- Assistant License and Document Examiner (AUX-LDEX)
- Prevention Outreach Specialist (AUX-MEES)
- Marine Safety Administrative and Management Specialist (AUX-MSAM)
- Port State Control Dispatcher (AUX-PSC)
- Assistant Waterways Management Representative (AUX-WM)

Marine Safety and Prevention Program

The Coast Guard Auxiliary Marine Safety qualifications are designed to facilitate and encourage Auxiliary support for Coast Guard Sectors in the legacy Marine Safety and Environmental Protection Programs. Some programs may be co-administered by state or local organizations. Examples include:

- Commercial Fishing Vessel Safety (CFVS) Examiner
- Assistant Life Raft Inspector (AUX-LR)
- Uninspected Passenger Vessel Examiner (AUX-UPV)
- Uninspected Towing Vessel Examiner (AUX-UTV)
- Prevention Outreach Specialist (AUX-MEES)
- Marine Safety Administrative and Management Specialist (AUX-MSAM)

Additional recognition includes:

- Marine Safety Training Ribbon
- Auxiliary Marine Safety (Trident) insignia

Recreational Boating Safety Visitation Program (PV)

Auxiliarists wishing to participate in the RBS Visitation program must meet the BQ status requirement of having successfully completed an authorized boating safety course. This means that members in AP status may train and qualify as PV provided they have successfully completed that BQ status requirement and all other qualification requirements described in the following references.

Auxiliary Vessel Examiner (VE)

Auxiliarists wishing to participate in the VE program must meet the BQ status requirement of having successfully completed an authorized boating safety course. This means that members in AP status may train and qualify as VE provided they have successfully completed that BQ status requirement and all other qualification requirements described in the following references.

Auxiliary Vessel Examiners (VEs) are trained and qualified to perform safety examinations of different types of vessels. There are two distinct VE programs:

- VEs for recreational boats conduct Vessel Safety Checks (VSCs), administered under the VE and PV directorate.
- VEs for commercial vessels conduct vessel safety examinations, administered under Marine Safety in the Prevention Directorate.

Nothing precludes an Auxiliarist from qualifying and performing activity in both programs. These VEs are trained and qualified to perform VSCs and Auxiliary surface facility inspections.

Auxiliary Public Affairs Program

The Auxiliary Public Affairs training program combines formal and on-the-job training with structured mentoring into a four-tiered professional development program. This program develops skills in writing, photography, multimedia, public speaking, publications, social media, and marketing.

It is designed to develop Auxiliarists from public affairs apprentices, into skilled public affairs specialists, support specialists, and program managers.

An Auxiliarist does not have to serve as a public affairs program staff officer to train, complete, and qualify in this program.

Auxiliary Instructor (IT)

Instructors can teach either or both Auxiliary PE and/or MT courses. Auxiliarists wishing to participate in the IT program must meet the BQ status requirement of having successfully completed an authorized boating safety course. This means that members in AP status may train and qualify as IT provided they have successfully completed that BQ status requirement and all other qualification requirements described in the following references.

Additionally, experienced ITs shall serve as prime mentors in qualifying new ITs, improving the skills of current instructors, and assisting in the New Member program.

All new ITs will be qualified using the current IT Development Course (IDC) as follows:

- For IT qualification, the candidate completes the IDC, passes the open book examination with a three-hour time limit and passing grade of 90 percent, and teaches a minimum of two classes of satisfactory instruction under a certified IT's supervision.
- The supervising IT or an elected leader signs and dates the completed examination form stating IT qualifications have been met.

Auxiliary Interpreter Program

The Auxiliary Interpreter Corps program is a component of the Auxiliary International Affairs Directorate that provides Interpreter support to Coast Guard operational, administrative, and public affairs missions.

Members of the Coast Guard Auxiliary, whether or not they are also Coast Guard active duty, reserve, or civilian employees, may join the Auxiliary Interpreter Corps based on their linguistic skills.

Other Auxiliary Programs

The H-Directorate also oversees programs that are available for Auxiliary participation, such as the Culinary Assistant (AUXCA) program, Chaplains (ACS), Coast Guard Recruiting Support (CGRS), and Health Services (for Auxiliarists trained as MDs, DDS, RN, etc.).

Core Training

The purpose of Core Training (AUXCT) is to build awareness and enhance the knowledge, skills, abilities, and attitudes of the Coast Guard's workforce required to perform Coast Guard missions.

Auxiliarists must successfully complete the following AUXCT during their first year of enrollment and then once every five years thereafter:

- Workforce Resilience Training (502379)
- Security Fundamentals (810030)
- Privacy at DHS: Protecting Personal Information (810015)
- Sexual Harassment Prevention (810000)
- Civil Rights Awareness (502319)

Auxiliarists must successfully complete the following AUXCT only once (new members shall complete them by the end of their first full year after joining):

- Ethics 1- Personal Gifts (502306)
- Basic Qualification Course II (this course)

Member Involvement Plan (MIP)

The Coast Guard Auxiliary is committed to the personal and professional growth of all our members. This planner is to help you to become familiar with opportunities available in the Auxiliary, to see the steps leading to your interests and goals, and, overall, to assist you in planning your future years in the Auxiliary. Here is the planner link:

<http://hdept.cgaux.org/pdf/MemInvol16DEC10.pdf>

Performance Qualification System

Much of your operational training will be measured by a “Performance Qualification Standard” (PQS).

The PQS for each qualification is different, but generally includes:

- A series of components that may include completion of additional outside training
- A series of tasks, many of which are intended to be completed “on the job,” that must be performed in front of and signed off by a mentor

Competency might sometimes also be measured by a written (or online) examination, an interview with a qualification board, or by some other method.

AUXDATA II

AUXDATA II is a secured management information system used to enter all of the data pertaining to individuals, facilities, certifications, awards, and performance hours by qualified Auxiliarists. Any Auxiliarist can use the program to retrieve all information, but needs to be cautious that there is Personally Identifying Information (PII) that must not be used or copied unless allowed by Auxiliary guidance.

AUXDATAII is designed to assist Auxiliarists, Auxiliary leadership, the Director and the Chief Director, and the Security Center (SECCEN) in tracking, managing, and creating reports for implementation and management of the Personnel Security Investigation (PSI) program.

More information about accessing AUXDATAII can be found here:

<https://wow.uscgaux.info/content.php?unit=IT-GROUP&category=auxdata-ii>

Time Entry

Time spent on Auxiliary activities (performance hours) should be entered directly into AUXDATAII. However, if need be, forms can be submitted to the FSO-IS. PDFs of common forms including the 7029 and 7030 are available online:

<http://webforms.cgaux.org>

Form 7029 can be used to report miscellaneous “admin” time on a daily basis. There is one form for each month, organized as a day-by-day spreadsheet. This form is submitted to your FSO-IS for entry. The following codes designate type of time:

- 99A is AUX Leadership
- 99B is RBS support
- 99C is Marine Safety support
- 99D is training (including all time spent as a trainee in a class)
- 99E is admin

Form 7030 is used to report specific time devoted to specific missions. Most time as an instructor in a classroom is reported here. Each mission and sub-mission have a different code, for example:

- 01A is a “Marine Patrol
- 06B is “Instructor for Non-Operational Training”
- 10J is “Public Affairs Community Relations”
- There are approximately 80 other activity codes on the 7030 form

Uniforms

Proper wear of uniforms represents professionalism. Auxiliarists must adhere to uniform policies when engaged in Coast Guard or Auxiliary programs or activities.

Whenever in doubt, check Chapter 10 of the CG Auxiliary Manual for more detailed guidance. The H-Directorate also provides detailed information about all aspects of uniforms and grooming standards via the links here:

<https://wow.uscgaux.info/content.php?unit=H-DEPT&category=auxiliary-uniforms>

The uniform of the day is prescribed by the Director or elected leaders. Ask if you are unsure!

Take care and show pride in your appearance:

- Always wear a cover when outdoors and in uniform
- Replace uniform components when they are old, worn, or “no longer serviceable”
- Do not wear soiled, un-ironed, or un-polished uniform items
- Control costs by obtaining only the uniforms you need
- Be precise, consult the directives, and always look it up!

Rely on each other—help your shipmates. Remember that **“We represent the United States Coast Guard”**.

Additional Guidance on Wearing of Uniforms:

- Shirts, coats, jackets, overcoats and raincoats should be buttoned
- Windbreakers and jackets may be used with Tropical Blue and Winter Dress Blue uniforms if zipped at least 2/3 the way up
- Trousers shall not have cuffs and should touch shoe tops
- Skirt hemline will be no higher than the crease in the back of the knee nor lower than 2" below the crease
- Women may wear gold, silver or pearl earrings of round ball style or diamond studs with the Dinner Dress uniforms. Dangling or hoop earrings or jewelry or studs other than specified above shall not be through or attached to the ear, nose, tongue or any other visible body part while in uniform.
- Men cannot wear earrings
- Religious headgear shall not be worn in place of specified uniform headgear
- Visible tattoos and body piercing may not be visible above the collar line of a Tropical Blue shirt
- Men's hair or facial hair shall be neat and clean, be away from the ears and not touch the collar.

Know your combinations:

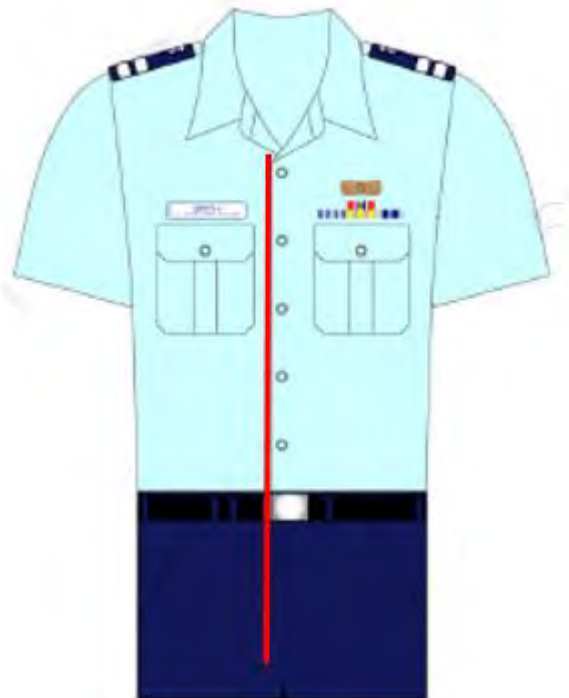
- Long sleeves demand a tie
- Boat shoes only work with the ODU when on a boat
- Bowties never go with nametags or ribbons, and always go with miniatures
- Large metal insignia are for your jacket shoulder epaulets, nothing else

Straighten your “Gig” Line

There is an imaginary line that connects the buttons on your shirt, the edge of your belt buckle, the silver tip of your belt, and the zipper of your trousers.

Make sure it is straight!

Women wearing the male pants should match their gig line between the belt and pants, but it will not align with the blouse. The belt direction should be reversed to achieve this.



Disposal of Uniforms

Whenever in doubt you should review Chapter 10 of the CG Auxiliary Manual for more detailed guidance on proper uniforms.

Disposing of uniforms:

- Useable uniforms may be given or sold to other Auxiliarists.
- Disposal is required when uniform items are worn or excessively faded.
- Any marking or identification sewn or stamped onto the uniform, which would identify an item as a Coast Guard or Auxiliary uniform item, shall be removed before disposal.

Human Resources



THE COMMANDANT OF THE UNITED STATES COAST GUARD
WASHINGTON, DC 20593

DIVERSITY AND INCLUSION POLICY STATEMENT

I am committed to improving diversity within the Coast Guard. The Coast Guard's strength resides in its people and the different perspectives, talents and abilities they bring to the Service. We gain much from the ideas and viewpoints of a workforce that reflects the richness of American society. Recruiting drives the composition of our workforce but we must do more than just recruit effectively. Retention of a high performing, diverse workforce is paramount to secure our mission success. We must respect those who serve with us. We must leverage diversity and we must be inclusive in order to achieve the highest level of mission excellence.

We will create and sustain a climate where people of diverse backgrounds are included, valued and respected. We will capitalize on the differences that each brings. A diverse workforce stimulates innovation, new approaches, and fresh perspectives to solve complex organizational challenges. Our Service benefits greatly when we incorporate diversity at all levels of the workforce: active duty, reserve, civilian, and Auxiliary. Diversity ultimately enables us to better perform our challenging maritime missions.

We must strive to create a culture where all individuals have the opportunity to prosper, advance in their careers, and contribute to Coast Guard missions. Our Diversity and Inclusion Strategic Plan will guide our efforts to achieve these goals. I encourage each member of our workforce to become familiar with the plan located on our diversity and inclusion website <http://www.uscg.mil/diversity>.

Join me in my personal commitment to make our Coast Guard the Service of choice for all Americans who seek to serve our Nation.

PAUL F. ZUKUNFT
Admiral, U.S. Coast Guard

Diversity

Auxiliarists serve in communities throughout the country, come from different social, religious, ethnic, and economic backgrounds, and join together to contribute their time and talents toward the common cause of supporting Coast Guard missions. They recognize diversity and strive to remove all barriers, real or perceived, so that current and potential Auxiliarists feel an increased pride and honor in their membership.

The Coast Guard Auxiliary has established three goals and several related objectives to support and promote diversity:

- Positive environment
- Value all Auxiliarists
- Promote individual success

Diversity Goal #1 - Positive Environment

Create a positive volunteer environment for managing membership diversity. Objectives to meet this goal are:

- Enlighten leaders to manage diversity as a membership retention issue.
- Achieve a diverse volunteer membership that represents all segments of the nation's population.
- Gain an understanding of current Auxiliary culture to enable the identification and removal of barriers to a positive environment for Auxiliarists.
- Ensure plans, resources, and policies fully support managing diversity.

Diversity Goal #2 - Value All Auxiliarists

Be an organization that highly values its volunteers and respects their differences.

Objectives to meet this goal are:

- Ensure leaders and Auxiliarists acknowledge, understand, and value differences.
- Recognize and reward individual and group contributions to managing diversity.
- Provide fair, equal, and rapid conflict resolution.
- Communicate effectively with all Auxiliarists.

Diversity Goal #3 - Promote Individual Success

Ensure all Auxiliarists have the opportunity to reach their full potential in the organization. Objectives to meet this goal are:

- Ensure every Auxiliarist understands task requirements and responsibilities and is coached and encouraged to achieve success.
- Remove or reasonably attempt to remove physical barriers to participation consistent with law, mission requirements, and safety.



THE COMMANDANT OF THE UNITED STATES COAST GUARD
Washington, DC 20593

ANTI-DISCRIMINATION and ANTI-HARASSMENT POLICY STATEMENT

Our Core Values of Honor, Respect and Devotion to Duty demand our commitment and dedication to a workplace free of discrimination and harassment. Sustained mission excellence requires it. Federal law and policy compel it. Our *duty to people* is founded upon it.

Discrimination and harassment are incompatible with our Service. We will respect those we serve and those who serve with us. We will cultivate and sustain a work environment that is free from conduct that unreasonably interferes with an individual's work performance or creates an intimidating, offensive or hostile work environment based on an individual's race, color, national origin, religion, sex (including sexual orientation), age, disability, genetic information, marital status, parental status, political affiliation, engagement in a protected Equal Employment Opportunity (EEO) activity or any other basis protected by the law. We will proactively address such conduct before it affects our people and our mission performance. Each Coast Guard member will be familiar with our EEO policies to prevent and eliminate all forms of discrimination and harassment.

The Coast Guard's Civil Rights Directorate website contains guidelines for appropriately reporting and responding to incidents of unlawful discrimination and harassment: <http://www.uscg.mil/hq/cg00/cg00h/>. Coast Guard members who believe they have been subjected to unlawful discrimination and/or harassment should report it, as well as any suspected retaliation or reprisal related to a harassment complaint. Reports shall be made promptly through the supervisory chain of command, the local Civil Rights or Human Resources Offices, or through other appropriate grievance procedures. All complaints and reports alleging unlawful discrimination and/or harassment will be processed promptly, thoroughly, impartially and through a process that protects privacy. In cases where it is determined that discrimination and/or harassment has occurred, leaders and managers will take immediate and appropriate corrective action.

At all times, we will provide an environment that promotes dignity, respect, fairness and inclusion. These are essential elements to the sustainment of operational excellence, a positive command climate and a healthy work environment. *It's who we are.*

PAUL F. ZUKUNFT
Admiral, U.S. Coast Guard

Anti-Discrimination/Harassment

The Coast Guard is committed to a workplace where no member of the workforce will be subject to physical or verbal harassment, abuse, violence, or discrimination based on an individual's race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, national origin, age, disability, marital status, parental status, political affiliation, or any other basis protected by law.

Simply, it is committed to an environment free of harassing and discriminatory behavior.

Harassment is generally defined as unwelcomed advances, requests for favors, and other physical and verbal conduct when such conduct explicitly or implicitly affects an individual's employment, unreasonably interferes with an individual's service performance, or creates an intimidating, hostile, or offensive environment.

This also encompasses unwelcome display or communication of sexually offensive materials.

Responsibilities

The Coast Guard and Auxiliary must have people serving together effectively to accomplish missions and are responsible for enabling and ensuring this for each member.

Fair Treatment

All persons are entitled to be treated fairly and with dignity and respect. All must be allowed to serve and to enjoy an environment free of unlawful discrimination and harassment.

Adverse Effects of Harassment

The economic costs of harassment are significant, but more harmful are the negative effects of harassment on productivity and readiness. These areas include increased absenteeism, greater personnel turnover, lower morale, and decreased effectiveness. Adverse actions also result in a loss of personal, organizational, and public trust. While not easy to quantify, these costs are real and seriously affect the Coast Guard and Auxiliary's ability to accomplish missions.

Prevention Through Leadership and Commitment

The key to preventing harassment is personal leadership and commitment. Those who serve in Auxiliary leadership and staff positions must commit themselves to constantly and consistently promoting equitable treatment.

Auxiliary leaders must convey this commitment clearly and unequivocally to all Auxiliarists by holding themselves and their Auxiliarists accountable. There must be firm determination to use these tools judiciously and in timely fashion in meeting the Commandant's goals.

Prevention of Gender Discrimination

Sexual harassment is a form of prohibited discrimination based upon sex or sexual orientation. Discrimination against people based upon their gender is also a significant problem.

Gender or sexual discrimination exists when a person is treated differently because of gender.

Prevention of gender discrimination must be pursued with the same vigor as that for preventing sexual harassment.

Coast Guard Policy

The Coast Guard is committed to maintaining an environment free from unlawful discriminatory practices and inappropriate behavior. In support of this commitment, the Coast Guard has issued a specific policy:

- All Auxiliarists will receive training in the areas of identification, prevention, resolution, and elimination of harassment.
- Individuals who believe they have been harassed shall be afforded the opportunity and venues to seek resolutions and remedy.
- All leaders within the chain of leadership and management will ensure that Auxiliarists are aware of the processes described in the AUXMAN through which to file reports of allegations of harassment.
- The Auxiliary shall not tolerate acts of reprisal, intimidation, or further acts of harassment.
- All Auxiliarists must be aware of available avenues of resolution and redress.
- All reported incidents of harassment should be resolved at the lowest possible level.
- All incidents should be resolved promptly and with sensitivity.
- Confidentiality will be maintained to the greatest extent possible.
- Counseling support or referral services will be made available for all persons involved in incidents of sexual harassment.

Assistance on the subject of harassment prevention is available through the Coast Guard Auxiliary Civil Rights Coordinator (CGAUX-CRC).

New Auxiliary enrollees shall successfully complete harassment prevention training as part of the Auxiliary Mandated Training (AUXMT) requirements specified in section E of Chapter 8 of the AUXMAN.

Rape and Sexual Assault

Zero Tolerance - Rape and sexual assault will not be tolerated in the Coast Guard.

These criminal acts violate the Coast Guard's core values. All Auxiliarists shall foster and maintain an environment of mutual respect and trust to ensure the safety and security of others.

Key elements of Rape and Sexual Assault awareness include:

- Mandatory annual training.
- Requirements to report allegations of rape or sexual assault to the Coast Guard Investigative Service (CGIS) for investigation in accordance with Mandatory Reporting of Incidents to the Coast Guard Investigative Service and Requesting Investigative Assistance, COMDTINST 5520.5 (series)
- Steps to ensure victims are not further traumatized by any investigation

Allegations of Rape or Sexual Assault

All allegations of rape or sexual assault by any member of the Coast Guard Auxiliary shall be immediately reported to the servicing CGIS office and the servicing Coast Guard legal office in accordance with Mandatory Reporting of Incidents to the Coast Guard Investigative Service and Requesting Investigative Assistance, COMDTINST 5520.5 (series).

All allegations will be promptly investigated by CGIS.

Directors or cognizant Coast Guard commands shall take appropriate disciplinary action, where evidence dictates, and report the action taken to the servicing CGIS and Coast Guard legal offices.



THE COMMANDANT OF THE UNITED STATES COAST GUARD
Washington, DC 20593

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EQUAL OPPORTUNITY POLICY STATEMENT

Our Active Duty, Reserve, Civilian and Auxiliary personnel are the foundation upon which the Coast Guard sustains mission excellence. Our *Duty to People* requires a workplace that, at all times, promotes professional growth and opportunity and upholds our Core Values of Honor, Respect and Devotion to Duty.

Every member of the Coast Guard is responsible for preventing and eliminating all forms of discrimination that violate law or policy including practices and procedures that discriminatorily impact our workforce, applicants for employment and those seeking to participate or receive benefits from Coast Guard-sponsored programs. Adherence to this principle is a requirement for Coast Guard service.

Leaders, Managers and Supervisors shall:

- Recruit, train, develop, promote, reward, retain and deploy a skilled and capable diverse workforce in a fair and consistent manner on the basis of merit.
- Ensure that opportunities in the Coast Guard are publicized to the widest extent possible to identify, from all areas of our country and all parts of our society, highly qualified applicants for enlistment, officer accession, civilian employment and Auxiliary enrollment.
- Maintain a work environment free from unlawful discrimination and harassment.
- Provide reasonable accommodations for qualified applicants and employees with disabilities.
- Ensure all men and women of the Coast Guard are educated about their rights and responsibilities under Federal civil rights laws.
- Act promptly, appropriately, and decisively in support of this policy to ensure personal accountability throughout the Coast Guard.

Every single member of our Coast Guard force has the right to expect and require equal and fair treatment with dignity and respect without any regard to race, color, national origin, religion, sex (including gender identity, sexual harassment, pregnancy and sexual orientation), age, disability, genetic information, marital status, parental status, political affiliation, engagement in a protected Equal Employment Opportunity (EEO) activity, or any other basis protected by law. Those who fail to demonstrate these tenets are in conflict with our Core Values and will be held accountable.

PAUL F. ZUKUNFT
Admiral, U.S. Coast Guard

Civil Rights

The Coast Guard Auxiliary is committed to ensuring protection of all Auxiliarists' civil rights. This section describes the provisions for the Auxiliary's Civil Rights Program. The Commandant is responsible for providing overall leadership and direction to ensure all policies and procedures contained in this section are in effect throughout the Coast Guard and Auxiliary.

Auxiliarists are otherwise excluded from all equal employment opportunity processes and procedures administered by the Coast Guard Office of Civil Rights (CG-00H) including program compliance evaluation, counseling, and complaint processes.

District Commanders are responsible for carrying out the spirit and intent of the Coast Guard's civil rights and equal opportunity programs. Each District or region's Coast Guard Auxiliary Civil Rights Coordinator (CGAUX-CRC) will be selected from experienced Auxiliarists (preferably past Division Commanders or higher) who possess the skills and desire to serve in such capacity.

The CGAUX-CRC is a Director's nomination with concurrence of the DCO. The nominee's name and qualifications will be submitted to the District Commander for approval. Upon approval, the District Commander will designate the nominee, in writing, as the CGAUX-CRC for that district or region. The Director may support CGAUX-CRC duty-related travel as resources may allow.

Auxiliary Recognition and Awards

Auxiliarists may wear ribbons and medals, as part of the uniform, as tangible evidence of certain awards received. It is important to note that ribbons and medals are worn in a prescribed order of precedence rather than in order of receipt. The proper sequence of ribbons worn can be established using the Auxiliary Ribbon Checker website at this link: <https://wow.uscgaux.info/content.php?unit=070-04&category=ribbon-checker>. Further guidance from the H-Directorate is available in the Ribbons presentation here: <https://drive.google.com/file/d/1QbmMJ-paq5izM55nPStDdwTKWFd1RT4Z/view>

Auxiliarists who provide documentation (*DD Form 214 or equivalent*) for U.S. military awards that are listed in Chapter 10 of the Auxiliary Manual, may wear the corresponding badges, ribbons, and/or medals in accordance with Auxiliary uniform regulations.

Auxiliarists authorized foreign awards may be worn provided at least one U.S. military or Auxiliary award is worn.

Privileges for Auxiliarists in AP Status

Auxiliarists in AP status are authorized to obtain and wear the Auxiliary uniform with proper devices and insignia of the current or highest past office held.

Auxiliarists in AP status may fly the Auxiliary Ensign on any currently inspected facility that displays a current facility decal, including vessel, aircraft, or radio facilities. They may also fly the Auxiliary Ensign on their own vessels that are not offered/accepted for use provided the vessel has successfully completed a Vessel Safety Check (VSC) and displays a current VSC decal. While underway, at least one Auxiliarist must be on board when flying the Auxiliary Ensign. Auxiliarists in AP status may also fly the Auxiliary Ensign on or near buildings or homes in which such facilities are located or in which the Auxiliarist resides. For information on flag placement on an Auxiliary facility, refer to the Auxiliary Operations Policy Manual, COMDTINST M16798.3 (series).

Auxiliarists in AP status may earn and wear appropriate Auxiliary and Coast Guard awards if they meet established award criteria. Appropriate AUXDATA entries shall be made to reflect these awards.

Auxiliarists in AP status may participate on Auxiliary committees (e.g., Flotilla Change of Watch committee).

Auxiliarists in AP status may participate in Auxiliary ceremonial events (e.g., Emcee of a Change of Watch; member of an Auxiliary color guard).

Auxiliary Awards

Auxiliarists, as volunteers, receive no direct compensation for the many hours of time and effort they donate to the Coast Guard. The recognition of an Auxiliarist's service, through the presentation of timely and appropriate awards, is essential to the success of the Auxiliary program.

Medals and awards will be worn as prescribed in the Coast Guard Medals and Awards Manual, COMDTINST M1650.25 (series).

As with any aspect of Auxiliary service records, it is the incumbent responsibility of each Auxiliarist to ensure that timely, complete, and accurate changes are made to them. Auxiliarists are therefore highly encouraged to provide the Director with a copy of any award (i.e., certificate and/or citation) as soon as practicable after their receipt of such.

Auxiliary Awards

Coast Guard Unit and Service Awards

The Coast Guard issues unit and service awards that Auxiliarists are eligible to receive and wear. Award eligibility criteria are described in the Coast Guard Medals and Awards Manual, COMDTINST M1650.25 (series).

Applicable Non-Military Awards

Auxiliarists are eligible to receive and wear certain non-military awards. Detailed information about Auxiliary awards including ribbons, devices and medals can be found via the H-Directorate at: <https://drive.google.com/file/d/1QbmMJ-paq5izM55nPStDdwTKWFd1RT4Z/view>.

Auxiliary Qualification Awards

Auxiliary qualifications may have corresponding insignia, worn above the left pocket. Metal insignia have corresponding embroidered insignia for specific uniforms. More information is available in the Uniform presentations from the H-Directorate.

Making a Recommendation

Military and Coast Guard civilian personnel are highly encouraged to make Auxiliary award recommendations, and may submit them directly to the appropriate chain of command. Any Auxiliarist may make an Auxiliary award recommendation via the chain of leadership and management to the designated Auxiliary awarding elected or appointed leader for consideration of all listed awards [except the Auxiliary Distinguished Service Medal (ADSM), Auxiliary Legion of Merit (ALOM), Auxiliary Plaque of Merit (APOM), and the Flotilla Meritorious Achievement].

Procurement of Awards

Any initial award issue should be provided through the Coast Guard at no cost to the Auxiliarist. Auxiliarists may purchase replacement Auxiliary ribbons, medals, and devices, for all appropriate awards and qualifications, from the AUXCEN through established district channels.

Replacement Coast Guard awards may be purchased through Department of Defense/Coast Guard exchanges or through the Auxiliary Center (AUXCEN).

Manner of Wearing Miniatures and Ribbon Attachments

Most Auxiliary awards, except the Specialty Award, have a corresponding miniature medal. More information can also be found via the H-Directorate presentation here: <https://drive.google.com/file/d/1QbmMJ-paq5izM55nPStDdwTKWFd1RT4Z/view>

When an award has no miniature medal, Auxiliarists may not wear the ribbon alone on dinner dress uniforms. Auxiliarists should wear only miniature medals and devices on dinner dress uniforms.

Auxiliarists may wear the AUXOP and past officer devices on dress uniforms.

Auxiliarists are not authorized to wear anchors, the letters “X” and “V”, and numerals on any Coast Guard or Auxiliary ribbons. Auxiliarists should remove these attachments from any existing Coast Guard or Auxiliary ribbons.

Regulations and Policies

The Coast Guard Auxiliary is a non-military organization administered by the Commandant under the direction of the Secretary of Homeland Security as prescribed in Title 14 U.S.C. – Section 3901.

The Auxiliary shall include such organizational elements and units as are approved by the Commandant, including but not limited to, a national board and staff (to be known as the ‘Auxiliary headquarters unit’), districts, regions, divisions, flotillas, and other organizational elements and units.

The Auxiliary organization and its officers shall have such rights, privileges, powers, and duties as may be granted to them by the Commandant, consistent with this title and other applicable provisions of law.

The National Board of the Auxiliary, and any Coast Guard Auxiliary district or region, may form a corporation under state law in accordance with policies established by the Commandant.

Except as provided in Title 14 under authorities of the Secretary, personal property of the Auxiliary shall not be considered property of the United States.

The Secretary may reimburse the Auxiliary, and each organizational element and unit of the Auxiliary, for necessary expenses of operation, maintenance, and repair or replacement of personal property of the Auxiliary.

The term “personal property of the Auxiliary” means motorboats, yachts, aircraft, radio stations, motorized vehicles, trailers, or other equipment that is under the administrative jurisdiction of the Coast Guard Auxiliary or an organizational element or unit of the Auxiliary and that is used solely for these purposes.

Title 33, of the Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) Chapter 1, Subchapter A, Part 5 gives power and authority to the Auxiliary. Except as provided in paragraphs (b) and (c) of 33 CFR 5.20, or otherwise limited by the Commandant, members of the Auxiliary assigned to duty will have the same authority in that duty’s execution as a member of the Coast Guard who is assigned to a similar duty.

Purpose of Auxiliary and Status of Members

The purpose of the Auxiliary is to assist the Coast Guard as authorized by the Commandant, in performing any Coast Guard function, power, duty, role, mission, or operation authorized by law.

Except as otherwise provided, a member of the Coast Guard Auxiliary shall not be considered a Federal employee and shall not be subject to the provisions of law relating to Federal employment, including those relating to hours of work, rates of compensation, leave, unemployment compensation, Federal employee benefits, ethics, conflicts of interest, and other similar criminal or civil statutes and regulations governing the conduct of Federal employees.

However, nothing in this subsection shall constrain the Commandant from prescribing standards for the conduct and behavior of members of the Auxiliary.

A member of the Auxiliary while assigned to duty shall be deemed to be a Federal employee only for the few specified purposes including Chapter 26 of Title 28 (popularly known as the Federal Tort Claims Act).

Communications with Other Agencies

Auxiliarists shall not communicate with officials of other Government agencies or members of Congress in the name of the Auxiliary, unless the Chief Director determines the recommendations or requests are consistent with the Coast Guard and Auxiliary policy and grants the Auxiliarist specific permission in advance of the communication.

The right of Auxiliarists to communicate directly with elected and appointed Government officials and agencies as private citizens is not restricted.

Neither official stationery nor Auxiliary titles shall be used in such communications.

Public Appearances

Auxiliarists may appear and testify as private citizens at legislative hearings or political meetings without Coast Guard approval.

If Auxiliarists appear and/or testify as a private citizen on a matter related to the Coast Guard or the Auxiliary, they must provide the Chief Director and the local Director with advance notification.

If Auxiliarists appear and/or testify in a private capacity, they may not wear the uniform, use an Auxiliary title, or otherwise indicate that they represent the Coast Guard or the Auxiliary.

Marketing and Public Affairs

Auxiliarists participating in the Auxiliary Marketing and Public Affairs Program shall direct their efforts toward publicizing the Auxiliary's aims, purposes, and activities.

Since the Auxiliary is a working part of the Coast Guard, the Director should clear, before release, publicity releases concerning pending activities. The Director may delegate this responsibility to the DSO-PA/ADSO-PA, SO-PA, or FSO-PA.

Routine Auxiliary items such as write-ups of meetings, cruises, elections, PE courses, and other local activities do not require prior clearance.

Clippings of the published items shall be forwarded to the Director.

Personally Identifiable Information

The treatment and handling of Auxiliary Personally Identifiable Information (PII) and Auxiliary correspondence shall be in accordance with pertinent Coast Guard directives.

Personally Identifiable Information is defined as data that can be used to distinguish or trace a person's identity. Examples include: name, date of birth, home mailing address, telephone number, social security number, e-mail address, account numbers, certificate/license numbers, biometric identifiers (e.g., fingerprints), photographic images, and other information where it is reasonably foreseeable that the information will be linked with other personal identifiers of the individual.

As a policy matter, rosters of Auxiliarist names, home addresses, home telephone numbers, and any other PII associated with mailing lists shall not be made available to any external person or organization, nor used for any non-Auxiliary purpose. Privacy of all rosters shall be maintained.

Official Business Mail

The U.S. Coast Guard Postal Manual COMDINST M5110.1 (series) authorizes the privilege of official business mail for mailing of Federal Government mail. Such mail is defined as official mail relating exclusively to the business of the U.S. Government.

The Commandant extends this privilege to the Auxiliary. Regionally, the Director may grant the capability for use of official business mail to the Auxiliary leadership. Further, the Director's authority may be delegated by Auxiliary leadership to individual Auxiliarists. Auxiliary unit leaders are responsible for controlling the use of all official business mail materials.

Reimbursement of Auxiliarists

When an Auxiliarist is under Coast Guard orders, they are assigned to duty. Examples of this are to attend C-Schools, go on boat patrols, or go on aircraft patrols.

Coast Guard Orders:

Only when under written reimbursable Coast Guard orders does the Auxiliarist have an expectation of compensation for their expenses. This is covered in 14 U.S.C. § 3912 that states in part: *“When any member of the Auxiliary is assigned to such duty he may, pursuant to regulations issued by the Secretary, be paid actual necessary traveling expenses, including a per diem allowance in conformity with standardized Government travel regulations in lieu of subsistence, while traveling and while on duty away from his home.”*

Therefore, reimbursement for Auxiliary travel to, from, and during officially assigned duty (CG orders) will be consistent with the prevailing per diem rates authorized for Federal civilian employees and administered pursuant to provision in the Federal travel regulations.

Auxiliarists, as volunteers dedicated to helping support Coast Guard missions, often expend significant amounts of personal resources to effectuate such support. It is, therefore, incumbent upon each Coast Guard order issuing authority to clearly and comprehensively consider its capacity to reimburse Auxiliarists for authorized expenses, completely or to the extent to which the availability of its own resources allow.

Non-Reimbursable Coast Guard Orders (re AUXMAN section 9.A.3)

On the other hand, the Auxiliarist can be assigned to duty e.g. Vessel Exams at a boat ramp, manning a PA booth at a boat show, or traveling as a program visitor, without being under written Coast Guard orders. In such cases, there is no expectation of reimbursement of expenses.

Other possibilities are that an Auxiliarist may be traveling under orders of the Coast Guard Auxiliary Association or under funding by their District e.g. DTRAIN instructors. Funding in these cases will be determined by the orders issued.

Taxes

The IRS has determined the Auxiliary and all of its units (not including any corporations) are an integral part of the Federal Government. Unreimbursed out-of-pocket transportation expenses incurred in the use of facilities in the performance of Coast Guard and Auxiliary missions may be deductible.

Such operation, maintenance, and repair costs may be deductible only when they are directly attributable to Auxiliary services.

Auxiliarists must consult a qualified tax advisor and not rely upon the information contained in these materials when making tax decisions.

Publications

An individual serving as an Auxiliarist is prohibited from receiving any compensation for articles related to the Coast Guard or the Auxiliary, which are produced as a result of such service.

Feature articles on Auxiliary topics prepared by Auxiliarists for commercial periodicals, articles for organizations' publications, or Coast Guard internal publications are encouraged.

The DIR-A, or a DVC specifically appointed for that purpose, must approve the article before publication.

Social Media

Guidelines:

- Ensure accuracy and propriety of all Auxiliarists postings
- Adhere to Coast Guard regulations and policies regarding Operations and Information Security
- Adhere to the Privacy Act
- *Do not* post inappropriate material inconsistent with Coast Guard core values
- *Do not* advocate regarding policies or positions related to Coast Guard matters
- *Do not* disclose protected information

Assignment to Duty

The Commandant employs the services of qualified Auxiliarists in support of various Coast Guard programs. To this end, specific Auxiliary activities are authorized in support of Auxiliary programs or Coast Guard units.

An Auxiliarist performing such duties is considered to have been assigned to duty within the meaning of 14 U.S.C. §392 and §3902 when these activities have been authorized and clearly communicated verbally and/or in writing by appropriate authority e.g. the responsible FSO or the FC of the member's flotilla.

The Commandant has specifically delegated the authority to assign qualified Auxiliarists to duty for authorized activities. Assignment to duty is commonly made by a Coast Guard order issuing authority (e.g., a Coast Guard station commander who assigns an Auxiliary boat crew to a patrol). In some cases, an Auxiliarist may make the assignment to duty (e.g., a Flotilla Commander who issues an administrative assignment to a flotilla staff officer). Additionally, in many circumstances, an Auxiliarist's assignment to duty may be constituted by the Auxiliarist's actual performance of an authorized activity or mission (e.g., an Auxiliarist who performs Vessel Safety Checks at a marina without any formal orders issued).

Determination of Assignment to Duty

The protections under Assignment to Duty are contingent upon a favorable determination that the Auxiliarist was acting within the scope of employment as a Federal employee. Two outside agencies, the Department of Labor (DOL) and Department of Justice (DOJ), make that determination under Federal law. The Auxiliarist's assignment to duty is a requirement before any statutory protections are available.

If the Auxiliarist is not assigned to duty, then the Auxiliarist cannot be characterized as a Federal employee and therefore cannot be acting within the scope of employment.

Claims, Injury, or Death While Assigned to Duty

An Auxiliarist who is physically injured or dies while performing assigned duties may be entitled to statutorily prescribed medical treatment and/or death or disability compensation. The DOL will make a final determination as to whether an Auxiliarist was acting as an employee within the scope of employment when performing assigned Coast Guard duties as a Federal employee.

A member of the Auxiliary may be entitled to benefits when he/she is injured or dies while performing duties assigned by competent Coast Guard authority.

An Auxiliarist's performance of duty is defined to include time engaged in traveling back and forth between the place of assigned duty and the Auxiliarist's permanent residence.

The question is whether the Auxiliarist is traveling to an assigned duty location to, "perform duties assigned by competent Coast Guard authority."

Other than certain specific exceptions defined in Department of Labor Publication (CA-810), Federal employees do not have the protection of the Federal Employee Compensation Act (FECA) when injured in route between the home and place of work.

Auxiliarists do not gain the protection of FECA when traveling from home to their regular flotilla meeting, or vice versa. Attendance at a regular flotilla meeting is not the performance of duty assigned by competent Coast Guard authority at an assigned place of duty.

Coast Guard & Auxiliary Activities

Members of the Auxiliary who incur physical injury or contract sickness or disease while performing any duty to which they have been assigned by a competent Coast Guard Authority may be entitled to the same medical treatment afforded members of the Coast Guard.

Auxiliarists injured while assigned to duty and requiring immediate attention should obtain emergency care from the nearest medical facility using their personal health insurance.

For any accident or incident that occurs while assigned to duty, notification of the facts and circumstances must be made to the Director, OIA, the Auxiliary legal advisor and the Auxiliarist's insurance company as soon as possible.

Third Party Claims

The Auxiliarist may be exonerated from liability to injured parties or damage to property, but this action depends on facts and circumstances surrounding the Auxiliarist's involvement in the incident.

Third party claims against Auxiliarists will be treated in the same manner as claims against other Coast Guard personnel under similar circumstances.

The DOJ will make a final determination in certifying the Auxiliarist as an employee within the scope of their employment conducting authorized Coast Guard duties as a Federal employee. This determination will be based on the recommendation from the Coast Guard Office of Claims and Litigation (CG-0945).

Solicitations, Gifts and Donations

All Auxiliarists, including all district corporation members, when acting in their capacity as Auxiliarists, are prohibited from soliciting any gift of any type from any federal or non-federal source for themselves, any family member, any private organization, any commercial entity, or any other federal or non-federal entity except as described below:

- Any solicitation must be for the support of an Auxiliary program(s) from which an Auxiliary unit will receive benefit.
- Any solicited gift source must be within the soliciting unit's area of responsibility.
- The market value of each solicited and accepted gift cannot exceed \$2,500.
- The aggregate market value of all gifts solicited and accepted from any particular gift source cannot exceed \$5,000 per calendar year.

Ethical Standards

Public service is a public trust, requiring Auxiliarists to place loyalty to the Constitution, ethical principles, the laws, the governing policies established by the Commandant of the Coast Guard above private gain.

- Auxiliarists should not hold financial interests that conflict with the conscientious performance of their authorized Auxiliary activities.
- Auxiliarists shall not engage in financial transactions using non-public Government information or allow the improper use of such information to further any private interest.
- Auxiliarists shall satisfy in good faith their obligations as citizens, including all just financial obligations, especially those such as Federal, State, or local taxes that are imposed by law.
- Auxiliarists shall adhere to all laws and regulations that provide equal opportunity for all Americans regardless of race, color, religion, sex, national origin, age, or handicap.
- Auxiliarists shall endeavor to avoid any actions creating the appearance that they are violating the law or the ethical standards set forth herein.
- Whether particular circumstances create an appearance that the law or those standards have been violated shall be determined from the perspective of a reasonable person with knowledge of the relevant facts.
- Auxiliarists shall refrain from comments among service members and media that unreasonably criticize, attack, or disparage the service.

Support and Basic Materials

The basic law that authorizes the Auxiliary also provides that Coast Guard resources and facilities may be employed in Auxiliary administration and operation, and certain appropriations may be made available for such purposes.

The Coast Guard may provide the Auxiliary with use of:

- Available Coast Guard shore facilities for Auxiliary meetings and for conducting authorized educational and training programs
- Appropriate Coast Guard training aids and operational equipment such as (but not limited to) dewatering pumps, computers, fax machines, radios and pagers
- Services of Coast Guard personnel assigned to administrative, training, and educational activities
- Coast Guard Exchanges for the purchase of goods and services

Auxiliary National Supply Center (ANSC)

The Coast Guard maintains the ANSC, which is operated at Government expense by a commercial contractor.

ANSC supplies Auxiliary units with a wide variety of training, recognition, administration, and program support materials. These materials include publications, forms, manuals, pamphlets, posters, CDs, and the initial issue of Auxiliary medals and awards.

Only materials approved by Commandant (CG-BSX-1) may be stocked and distributed by ANSC. Only Auxiliary unit elected leaders, National staff members, unit Materials Officers (MA), and Directors may place orders with the ANSC.

Auxiliary Center (AUXCEN)

The AUXCEN stocks Auxiliary flags, pennants, burgees, certain uniform accessories, and public education (PE) materials.

These items are available for sale through district materials centers at conferences and by direct mail via <https://auxcen.com/>.

Auxiliarists should not confuse the ANSC with the AUXCEN. Coast Guard Auxiliary Association, Inc. (CGAuxA, Inc.) operates the AUXCEN.

Course Materials

The Chief Director reviews and approves all official Coast Guard Auxiliary PE course materials.

CGAuxA, Inc. develops, prepares, prints, and supplies these items for Auxiliary use to conduct the PE program. These items are distributed through flotilla MA staff officers.

CGAuxA, Inc. has copyrighted this material, with all rights reserved. CGAuxA, Inc., or its designated representative, must grant permission for use of this material on requests prior to its use outside the Auxiliary.

Government Property

An Auxiliary unit may be granted written permission for long-term use and occupancy of Federal real property (buildings and land). Use and occupancy must be for authorized Auxiliary activities. A District Commander must consider such use as necessary and desirable. The Auxiliary unit must follow all legal provisions for property use.

Property in which the Coast Guard or another Federal agency has the title or right, or which is excess or surplus, may be requested for Auxiliary use. Such a request is subject to the necessary operational, engineering, and budgetary approval stated in the Real Property Management Manual, COMDTINST M11011.13 (series).

Coast Guard Personal Property

Auxiliarists, loaned or given custody of Coast Guard or Auxiliary owned personal property, may use said property for authorized activities only. The property, loaned or obtained, shall be accounted for in the appropriate Coast Guard authority's property inventory records and returned to the Government upon request.

Auxiliarists shall return property upon ending Auxiliary membership, transferring to retired status, or to another unit, or if the property is no longer needed. Auxiliarists shall immediately report the loss, damage, or theft of Coast Guard property to the appropriate Coast Guard authority.

Appropriated Funds

Auxiliary activity support entails the budgeting of appropriated funds. Appropriated funds may be budgeted to support the purchase of property, equipment, and materials such as:

- Office furnishings and labor-savings devices.
- Training devices, equipment, and texts.
- Classroom equipment and furnishings.
- Public relations equipment.
- Communications equipment.
- Portable generators and pumps.
- Tools for building and grounds improvement and maintenance.
- Boats and other operational equipment.
- Any other equipment or material considered appropriate by the District Commander to support mission needs.

Coast Guard Issued Property

The Coast Guard may purchase, loan, or issue property to Auxiliary units and it will be documented by custody receipts. The Auxiliary unit must show a definite need for the equipment for Auxiliary purposes. Under no circumstances will such property be transferred to an Auxiliary unit for the full or part-time private use of any Auxiliarist.

The equipment will be treated as Coast Guard property in accordance with provisions of the Property Management Manual, COMDTINST M4500.5 (series), while in custody of the Auxiliary unit. Appropriate Coast Guard authorities will report and account for all items in their property inventory records.

Each Auxiliary unit will conduct, as a minimum, an annual physical inventory count of all items on loan to them from the Coast Guard and provide a written report of such to the appropriate Coast Guard authority. Government furnished equipment is authorized for use to support Auxiliary PE efforts.

Excess Government Property

Excess Government property includes those items no longer required for Federal purposes, however, other Federal agencies may still need the property. Under Federal Property Management Regulations, excess personal property must be referred to the General Services Administration (GSA) for screening by other Federal agencies. Such action must be done before GSA can make a surplus declaration.

Once the property has been determined to be excess, the steps required for property disposal are complex and lengthy.

Auxiliary Leaders

All elected and appointed leaders shall develop and maintain property records, data, and documents appropriate for their office. Leaders shall account for these items and transfer them to their successors.

The same procedure is followed for any Coast Guard, Auxiliary, or other accountable property, money, manuals, and equipment. Leaders shall annually account for all such property and funds on Auxiliary unit inventories, whether replaced in office or not.

Memorandums of Understanding and Agreement

A Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) is a document that describes very broad concepts of mutual understanding shared by the parties.

A Memorandum of Agreement (MOA) is a document that describes in detail the specific responsibilities of, and actions to be taken by, each of the parties so that their mutual objectives can be achieved.

A MOU or MOA may be used to ensure that all parties involved in a cooperative effort or partnership are aware of the associated objectives, plans, and expectations. MOUs/MOAs shall be composed, formatted, and processed in accordance with provisions of Memoranda of Understanding/Agreement, COMDTINST 5216.18 (series).

General Services Administration

The Coast Guard has a cooperative policy agreement with the Public Building Service of the GSA concerning Coast Guard Auxiliary use of available space in GSA-controlled buildings to conduct PE courses.

Conveniently located GSA-controlled building spaces, largely in metropolitan areas, should, if made available to the Auxiliary, provide valuable additional classroom resources. When potential classroom spaces are under its control, GSA has agreed to help the Coast Guard. Such actions are subject to the Federal Property Management Regulations.

Other Agencies and Partnerships

Reservoirs, impoundments, and other recreational water resource projects are popular among thousands of boaters who trailer boats from inland areas.

Many boaters have had little or no boating safety indoctrination. To help with such instruction, liaisons have been established with applicable agencies. Various agencies help the Auxiliary promote VSCs and PE activities on water resource projects under their control. These agencies include:

- U.S. Army Corps of Engineers.
- National Park Service.
- Bureau of Land Management Tennessee Valley Authority.

Coast Guard Work Life Program

Auxiliarists may take full advantage of various benefits from the Coast Guard Work-Life Program. Auxiliarists are entitled to participate in any program benefit, other than those for which the Coast Guard pays a per capita basis fee. Auxiliarists may contact their Director to learn about available benefits and application details.

The Coast Guard's Work-Life delivery system identifies and responds to Auxiliarists' individual and family member needs. Information and referral services are provided through District Work-Life staff members.

Coast Guard Mutual Assistance Program

Coast Guard Mutual Assistance (CGMA) is a program set up to give aid in time of certain emergency or educational needs. The Mutual Assistance Program is available to assist all members of the Coast Guard family, including Auxiliarists.

Auxiliarists may write for applications and supplemental information forms to the following address: Coast Guard Mutual Assistance, 4200 Wilson Boulevard, Suite 610, Arlington, VA 22203-1804 or go to their web site at www.cgmahq.org.

Member Identification Cards

Auxiliarists in Approval Pending (AP) status shall be issued member identification numbers as part of the approval of their enrollment packages by the Director. These ID cards are used for entrance to Coast Guard facilities.

Auxiliarists in AP status may be issued an Auxiliary ID card that reflects their AP status if they satisfactorily complete the Provisional member program after 90 days of membership.

Auxiliarists in AP status should never be placed in the position of having to attempt to gain access to a Coast Guard facility alone. Mentors and Auxiliary leaders are to ensure Auxiliarists in AP status have an Auxiliarist in Basically Qualified (BQ), or Auxiliary Operations Specialist (AX) status as an escort if access to a Coast Guard facility is required.

Sample Membership Identification Card

DEPARTMENT OF HOMELAND SECURITY UNITED STATES COAST GUARD AUXILIARY				
		PHOTO WITH RED BACKGROUND HERE		
		RICHARD H. JONES, JR.		
STATUS: MEMBER	QUAL: BQ	EMPLID #: 1234567		
ISSUED BY: _____				
U.S. COAST GUARD AUXILIARY				

DATE OF BIRTH	WEIGHT	HEIGHT	HAIR COLOR	EYE COLOR
1960SEP30	175	73	BROWN	BROWN

AUTHORIZED PATRONAGE						
COAST GUARD EXCHANGE/MWR						

DATE OF ISSUE	EXP. DATE	BLOOD TYPE	GENEVA CONV. CATEGORY
2008NOV07	2013NOV30	UNK	IV

This card is the property of the United States Coast Guard, and is issued for official purposes and for identification only. Improper use, possession, or alteration is subject to the penalties under Title 18, USC 409, 506 and 701. If found, return to:
United States Coast Guard
Commandant (CG 5421)
Washington, DC 20593-6000
Return Postage Guaranteed

COAST GUARD AUXILIARY performs essential duties for the Federal Government in support roles to the UNITED STATES COAST GUARD in non-law enforcement and non-combat roles as search and rescue missions, boating education, vessel safety checks, environmental protection missions and aids to navigation. Please provide any assistance necessary to the bearer of this card in reaching his/her duty assignment. Authorized medical care while under competent orders.

NON-MILITARY ID

GENEVA CONVENTIONS IDENTIFICATION CARD - FORM 2650A

Reimbursement of Auxiliarists

14 U.S.C. § 3912 states, “*When any member of the Auxiliary is assigned to such duty he may, pursuant to regulations issued by the Secretary, be paid actual necessary traveling expenses, including a per diem allowance in conformity with standardized Government travel regulations in lieu of subsistence, while traveling and while on duty away from his home.*”

Reimbursement for Auxiliary travel to, from, and during officially assigned duty will be consistent with the prevailing per diem rates authorized for Federal civilian employees and administered pursuant to provision in the Federal travel regulations.

Types of Orders

Non-reimbursable orders do not entitle the Auxiliarist to any type of reimbursement. These orders are issued to properly recognize that an Auxiliarist is assigned to duty and to provide liability coverage for the Auxiliarist while performing duties for the Coast Guard.

Trip orders

Reimbursable or non-reimbursable, are issued to an Auxiliarist to attend a specific function (conference, meeting), for a specific time frame, at a specific location.

Monthly/quarterly orders

Reimbursable or non-reimbursable, are normally used for an Auxiliarist who serves at a certain station or office on a regular basis over an extended period of time. The purpose of this type of order is to reduce the administrative need to issue the same orders many times over a period of time.

Patrol orders

Reimbursable or non-reimbursable, are issued by an order issuing authority using the AUXDATA Order Management System (AOM) to order the use of an Auxiliary Facility (AUXFAC) such as an approved vessel, airplane, motorized vehicle, or communication station.

Verbal Orders

In times of emergency or critical operational need, an Auxiliarist may receive verbal orders to proceed on a mission. The orders must be noted in the logs of the Coast Guard unit issuing the orders and must be followed up with written orders as soon as conditions permit.

Invitational orders

Normally reserved for individuals who are not associated with the Coast Guard or the Auxiliary (e.g., the non-Auxiliary spouse of an Auxiliarist who is authorized to be issued Coast Guard travel orders).

These orders authorize the travel of a civilian at the Government's expense for the purpose of supporting a Coast Guard mission or activity.

Foreign Travel Orders

All Auxiliarists who conduct foreign travel for the Coast Guard must have written orders in hand prior to departure from the U.S.

Coast Guard TAD Orders

Auxiliarists are normally assigned to temporary additional duty (TAD) using Form CG-4251.

Coast Guard Auxiliary Funded Orders

The procedures for reimbursement under Auxiliary funded orders are contained in the Auxiliary's Fiscal Policy Guide.

Questions regarding these procedures should be referred to the Treasurer, CGAuxA, Inc.

Miscellaneous

Auxiliarists are eligible for reimbursement of actual expenses of operations when using their facility in conjunction with Coast Guard orders. The actual necessary expenses of operation are defined as including fuel, oil, power, water, supplies, and provisions used in the conduct of those orders. Other expenses for landing fees, ramp fees, and miscellaneous costs will be reimbursed separately from maintenance and fuel.

Reimbursement Guidelines

Auxiliarists traveling on official orders may be authorized per diem. Per diem is provided to cover the costs of lodging, meals, and certain incidentals while traveling. Receipts for any lodging, airfare, and receipts for any other expenses (e.g., approved rental car cost, taxi/limo fare) that are \$75 or more must be included with the travel.

Specific questions regarding travel policies should be referred to the local civilian travel management specialist or the Authorized Certifying Officer (ACO). Additional information about Coast Guard travel policies can be found at the Coast Guard Pay and Personnel Center (PPC) web site: <http://www.uscg.mil/ppc/tvl.asp>.

Travel Claim Procedures

The final step for any travel process is the filing of a travel claim to liquidate and reimburse travel expenditures. Two major Coast Guard commands are involved in the processing and reimbursement of travel claims:

- The Coast Guard Pay and Personnel Center (PPC) located in Topeka, KS.
- The Coast Guard Finance Center (FINCEN) located in Chesapeake, VA.

PPC effectively reviews and conducts periodic audits of travel claims once they have been submitted from an order issuing authority.

FINCEN effectively executes payment of the claimed expenses that have been approved for reimbursement.

Travel Claim Processing

The Coast Guard makes payroll and claim reimbursements to personnel through its Direct Deposit (DD)/Electronic Fund Transfer (EFT) program (this includes claims for travel, damages, official expenses). It allows the Coast Guard to effect payments and reimbursements via DD/EFT quickly, securely, and directly to the bank account specified by the individual/claimant. This eliminates a lot of time, cost, and administrative overhead associated with processing, printing, and mailing payroll and reimbursement checks.

DD/EFT is required for all Coast Guard active duty, Reserve and civilian personnel.

DD/EFT is mandatory for Auxiliarists.

In order to receive reimbursements from the Coast Guard for expenses associated with patrols, official travel, or any other claims (e.g., equipment damage), an Auxiliarist must have established DD/EFT service. Failure to establish DD/EFT service shall constitute grounds for denial of assignments to duty, issuance of official orders, and reimbursement of claims.

Customs, Courtesy, & Protocol

Good Relationships Begin with Respect. Always politely and cheerfully return a greeting given to you. Combine appropriate greeting and appropriate model of address:

- “Good morning, Senior Chief”, “Good afternoon, Mr. Welch”, “Good evening, Commodore”.
- Greet (and salute, if outside/applicable) the most senior officer present.

When communicating verbally:

- Admirals, Captains, Commanders, Commodores addressed by title.
- All other officers are addressed as “Mr.,” “Ms.,” “Sir,” or “Ma’am”.
- Chief, Senior Chief, Master Chief are all addressed by rank.
- Petty Officers are addressed as “Petty Officer”.

Auxiliarists sometimes communicate more informally.

Overview of the Officer Corps

In the Coast Guard, Commissioned Officers in grades O-1 through O-10 are referred to as Unrestricted Line Officers.

While Line Officers develop specific career paths, they are considered generalists, serving as leaders in many fields. Warrant Officers apply their enlisted training, and are considered specialists.

Grade – The position of an officer within the officer corps.; in the Coast Guard, the grades are divided into four categories.

- Warrant Officers
- Junior Officers
- Senior Officers
- Flag Officers

Table of Coast Guard Officers

Summary of active and reserve Coast Guard officers from most junior (left) to senior (right).

Warrant Officers					Junior Officers				Sr Officers		Flag Officers			
W-1	W-2	W-3	W-4	W-5	O-1	O-2	O-3	O-4	O-5	O-6	O-7	O-8	O-9	O-10
	CWO2	CWO3	CWO4		ENS	LTJG	LT	LCDR	CDR	CAPT	RDML	RADM	VADM	ADM
	Mr./Ms.	Mr./Ms.	Mr./Ms.		Mr./Ms.	Mr./Ms.	Mr./Ms.	Mr./Ms.	CDR	CAPT	Admiral	Admiral	Admiral	Admiral
Used in the CG					Used in the CG									

- Row One: Officer Groupings (Warrant, Junior, Senior or Flag)
- Row Two: Grades
- Row Three: Abbreviations of title
- Row Four: Proper address of the officer (title)

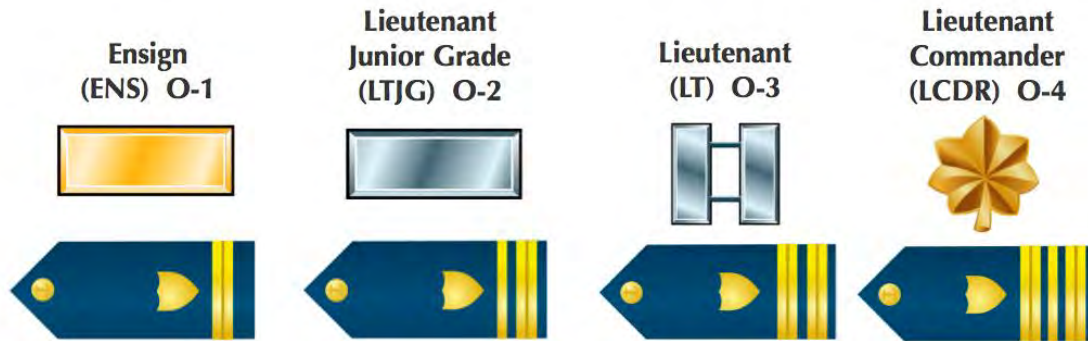
Warrant Officers

Formally addressed as Mr./Ms. or Sir/Ma'am, Warrant Officers are commissioned officers as well. They are former enlisted personnel with unique expertise.

		Chief Warrant Officer 2 (CWO2) W-2
		Chief Warrant Officer 3 (CWO3) W-3
		Chief Warrant Officer 4 (CWO4) W-4

Junior Officers

Formally addressed as Mr./Ms. or Sir/Ma'am, a LTJG may be introduced as "Lieutenant". A LCDR may be introduced as "Commander".



Senior Officers

Formally addressed by rank, introduced as "Commander" or "Captain".



Flag Officers (Admirals)

Formally addressed as "Admiral".



Determining Seniority

Warrant Officers

- Pictographic insignia worn on the left collar of the shirt, and on the Service Dress Blue (SDB) sleeves indicates technical specialty.
- Warrant Officer sleeves and shoulder board stripes have blue breaks over the gold. The “Five Minus Blue Rule” of determining seniority is such that when you subtract the # of blue breaks from the #5; the result equals the grade.

Line Officers

- The more stripes on the sleeve or shoulder, the more senior the officer.
- If the officer rank device is similar, silver will always outrank gold (for single bars and oak leaves).

Auxiliary and Active Duty/Reserve Officers

Active duty and reserve officers are military personnel, holding command authority in the form of commissions granted by the President of the United States.

Auxiliary officers are organizational and functional leaders, but are elected or appointed to their positions, not commissioned at a military rank, and consequently do not hold military-style command authority.

Enlisted Ranks and Grades

The Career Compensation Act of 1949 established uniform pay grades for officers and enlisted personnel in all military services. This law requires that the pay in a given grade must be the same, regardless of service.

By and large, ranks and grades in the U.S. military services are direct descendants from the British structure. There are nine grades in the enlisted ranks (E-1 to E-9). There is one ceremonial E-10, who is the Senior Enlisted member in each of the services.

The military services USCG, USN, USMC, USA, and USAF have large enlisted workforces. The other uniformed services (USPHS and NOAA Commissioned Corps), and the Coast Guard Auxiliary, have no enlisted corps.

Nomenclature and Definitions

Officers have a single rate (Ensign, Captain, etc.), but enlisted combine a “rate” and “rating.” This system applies to the Coast Guard and the Navy, and nomenclature within the two is similar:

- Rate – A designation that reflects a level of aptitude, training, experience, knowledge, and skill (Example: Seaman Apprentice-SA, 3rd Class Petty Officer-PO3, Chief Petty Officer-CPO).
- Rating – The name given to a specific occupation; requires basic aptitudes related to the specialty plus training, experience, knowledge, and skills. This system applies to the Coast Guard and the Navy, and nomenclature within the two is similar.
- USMC, USA, and USAF do not have Petty Officers and Chiefs.
- USCG and USN do not have privates or sergeants.

Table of Coast Guard Enlisted Members

Summary of Coast Guard enlisted personnel from most junior (left) to senior (right).

“Non Rates”			Petty Officers			Chief Petty Officers			
E-1	E-2	E-3	E-4	E-5	E-6	E-7	E-8	E-9	“E-10”
SR	SA	SN	PO3	PO2	PO1	CPO	SCPO	MCPO	MCPOCG
Last Name	Last Name	Last Name	Petty Officer	Petty Officer	Petty Officer	Chief	Senior Chief	Master Chief	Master Chief

- Row One: Groupings of personnel
- Row Two: Grade
- Row Three: Abbreviation of position
- Row Four: Appropriate address (title)

Seaman, Fireman, Airman

Regardless the number of slashes, you can distinguish a Seaman, Fireman, and Airman from one another based on the color of their rating badge:

- Seaman is the basic rate for all E-1 and most E-2 and E-3 personnel.
- Firemen are E-2 or E-3 in the engineering or damage control fields.
- Airmen are E-2 or E-3 in the aviation fields.



Seaman



Fireman



Airman

Petty Officers

Formally addressed as “Petty Officer”. May also be addressed by Rate/Rating, “BM2” or “ME3”.

Petty Officer
Third Class
(PO1) E-4



Petty Officer
Second Class
(PO2) E-5



Petty Officer
First Class
(PO1) E-6



Chief Petty Officers

Formally addressed as Chief Petty Officer, Senior Chief Petty Officer, or Master Chief Petty Officer. Referred to simply as “Chief,” “Senior Chief,” or “Master Chief” in common written or verbal communications.

Chief
Petty Officer
(CPO) E-7



Senior Chief
Petty Officer
(SCPO) E-8



Master Chief
Petty Officer
(MCPO) E-9



Master Chief Petty Officer of the Coast Guard (MCPOCG)

Each military service has one “E-10” that is the senior-most enlisted person in that branch of service. The MCPOCG is the principal advisor to the Commandant on quality of life, career development, work environment, and personal matters affecting enlisted personnel.

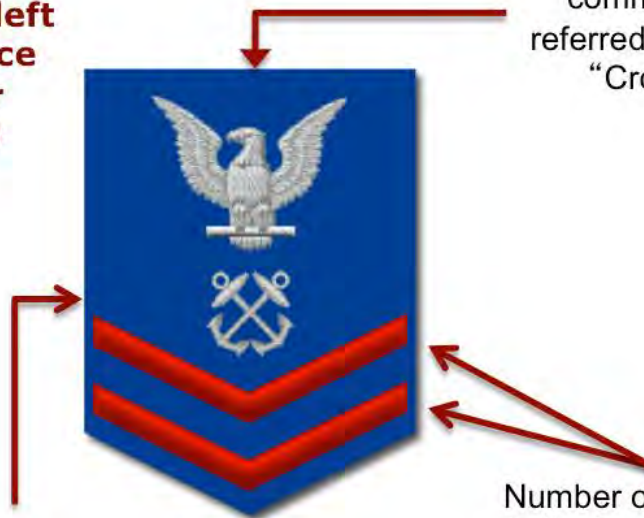
Normal tour of assignment is 4 years.



Enlisted Rating Badges

Worn on upper left sleeve of Service Dress Blue or Dinner Dress

Enlisted Eagle, commonly referred to as a “Crow”



Rating Specialty
 (“Crossed Anchors” = Boatswain’s Mate)

Number of chevrons indicate Pay Grade, or “Rate” (E-5/PO2)

Rates and Ratings as Abbreviations

E-1 and E-2 will have no rating; most E-3 personnel have no rating either. Personnel that have not yet earned a rating are collectively referred to as “non-rates.”

E-4 through E-9 Rating designation comes first:

- E-6 ... Rating + Rate = Abbreviation ... “BM1”
- E-7 ... Rating + C = Abbreviation ... “BMC”
- E-8 ... Rating + CS = Abbreviation ... “BMCS”
- E-9 ... Rating + CM = Abbreviation ... “BMCM”

Sample USCG Enlisted Ratings

	<u>Aviation Maintenance Technician (AMT)</u> A two-bladed winged propeller.		<u>Electronics Technician (ET)</u> A helium atom about which revolve two electrons.
	<u>Aviation Survival Technician (AST)</u> A winged flaming spherical shell with parachute.		<u>Food Service Specialist (FS)</u> Crossed quill and wheat spike with a key across top.
	<u>Avionics Electrical Technician (AET)</u> A winged helium atom about which revolves two electrons.		<u>Gunner's Mate (GM)</u> Crossed gun barrels with muzzles up.
	<u>Boatswain's Mate (BM)</u> Crossed anchors with crowns down.		<u>Health Services Technician (HS)</u> A caduceus.
	<u>Damage Controlman (DC)</u> Crossed fire axe and maul with handles down and axe blade to the front.		<u>Information Specialist (IT)</u> A globe with lines of embroidery representing lines of latitude and longitude, with a French type telephone above it.
	<u>Electrician's Mate (EM)</u> A globe with lines of embroidery representing lines of latitude and longitude.		<u>Intelligence Specialist (IS)</u> Crossed quill and lightning bolt, both pointing down; pen on top with quill to the back.

Coast Guard Auxiliary Officers

Auxiliary officers hold office, perform duties, and wear military style officer insignia, but they do not hold commissioned military rank.

Auxiliarists wear the insignia of the highest office held.

Auxiliarists are promoted when there is an opening at a higher level to which they are either elected or appointed.

Staff officers are appointed by a unit leader to perform the unit's staff duties or lead a staff program area.

Elected officers are selected by their peers, and are the unit commanders of Flotillas, Divisions, Districts, and the Auxiliary nation-wide.

Auxiliary leadership relies heavily on the ability of the leader to motivate and find consensus more so than it does on "rank".

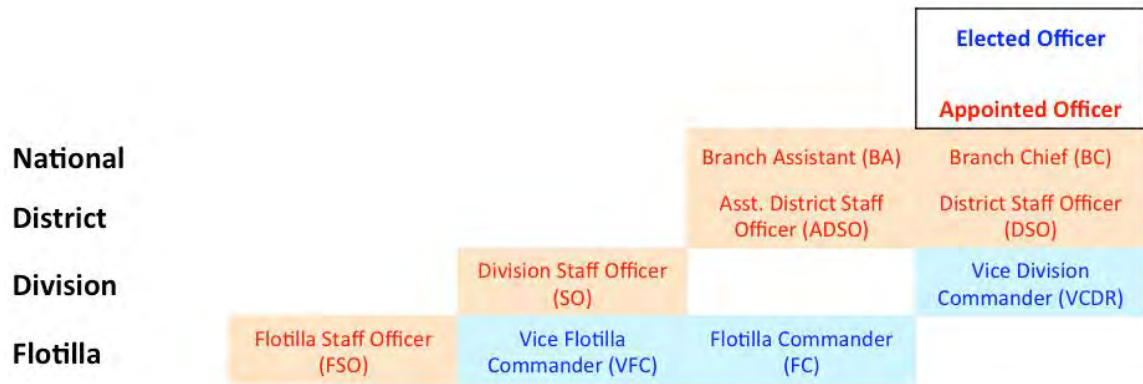
Auxiliary Officer Insignia

Auxiliary insignia are similar to active duty, with silver shoulder boards, sleeve lace, and buttons instead of the gold worn by active and reserve Coast Guardsmen.

Staff officers wear a red "A" on officer insignia. All other officers and members wear a silver "A" on their sleeves and shoulder boards, and a blue "A" on their metal insignia.



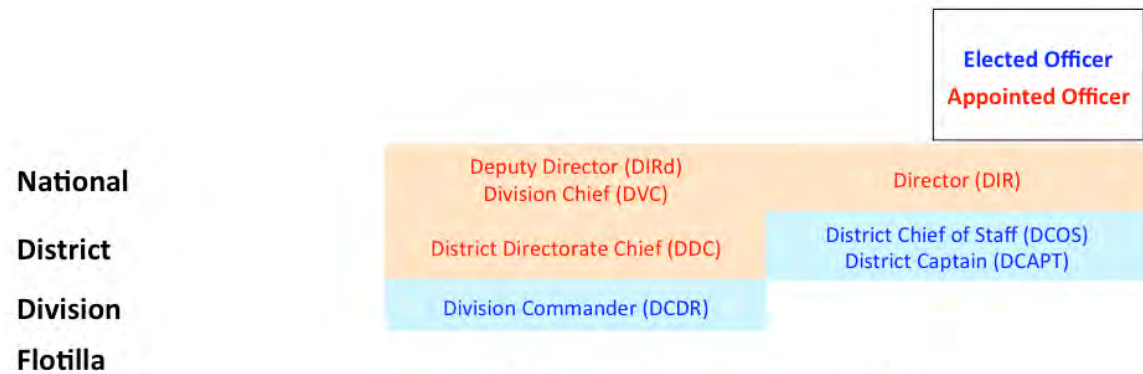
Auxiliary Junior Officers



Insignia



Auxiliary Senior Officers



Insignia



Auxiliary Flag Officers (Commodores)

Formally addressed as "Commodore"

- Abbreviated "COMO" for all levels.



Insignia



Auxiliary Specific Devices

Auxiliary Cap Device

- Larger size is used on combination cap
- Smaller is used with garrison
- Never worn on ODU ball cap



Past Officer Device

- Since Auxiliarists wear insignia from highest office held, signifies they are not currently serving in that position
- Worn to signify that a member's office
- Worn on right breast pocket



Customs, Courtesy, and Protocol

Courtesy is proper consideration for the feelings and rights of others. Protocol is the body of accepted rules of social behavior practiced by thoughtful and considerate people.

Customs and Protocol practiced in the Auxiliary are a part of ceremonial procedures that contribute dignity and color to our lives as members of the Coast Guard family.

The Auxiliary, as part of the Coast Guard family, must observe similar customs and protocols of the naval/sea services as well as the military even though Auxiliarists are civilians.

Auxiliarists are elected or appointed to positions of leadership, *not* command or rank.

Saluting as a Respectful Greeting

Salute when you are outdoors, in uniform, and covered. You must salute:

- A senior officer of a U.S. uniformed service or officer from a foreign government recognized by the United States
- A uniformed person who salutes you first

Simple rules to avoid an awkward moment:

- Always keep your right hand free—no cigarettes, cell phones, or pockets for either hand
- Salute those appearing to be senior to you (more stars/stripes)
- Do not salute someone who is not in uniform
- If you are in a work party, allow the work leader to offer the salute while you carry on; be sure to salute if you are the leader

Be warm and cheerful—remember that saluting is just a respectful greeting exchanged between those in uniform!

Saluting is Simple...

You are in uniform, outdoors, and under cover. You encounter a senior in uniform. It's time to salute.

- Look the senior in the eye with your head and body straight.
- In a fluid motion, raise your right upper arm parallel with the deck and forming an acute angle with your forearm.
- Lay hand flat with fingers together; finger tips just off brim of cover or eyebrows (when no brim).
- Slightly angle hand so you can see your palm.
- Offer a proper greeting ("Good evening, Ma'am", for example).
- Drop your salute when the senior has dropped his or hers.
- Carry on.

Politely greet and return any salute offered to you.

Proper Saluting Technique



The middle officer is correctly saluting as seen by:

- Head up, looking straight ahead (“Eyes in the boat”);
- Arm and hand straight, thumb together with your hand;
- Fingertips just off the brim of your cover

Saluting the Colors

When colors are sounded in the morning and afternoon/evening, you are to:

- Come to attention.
- Face the direction of the flag.
- Hold a salute (if in uniform) until the end.
- When on a military installation in a vehicle and traffic safety permits, stop and sit at attention, but do not salute.



Acknowledge and Comply

“Yes” and “No” signify acknowledgement or understanding. Examples are:

- “Yes, sir.”
- “No, ma’am.”
- “Yes, Admiral.”

“Aye-aye” signifies that you understand and will comply with a directive or request:

- “Aye-aye, Captain.”
- “Aye-aye, sir.”

These conventions are, like the formal models of address, often relaxed for Auxiliarists working together – the key is, again, to always be respectful and courteous to everyone with whom you interact.

Moving About

Move about quickly, quietly, and without fuss:

- Allow seniors to enter doors and hatches first—clear the passageway so they may pass, and open a door if necessary.
- When walking abreast to others, keep your immediate senior to your right and your immediate junior to your left
- When walking and overtaking a senior, come abreast to his/her left, salute and say “By your leave sir/ma’am”, and drop your salute and pass only when the senior acknowledges and drops his/her salute.
- When in a group, juniors are an extension of the senior person; they render or return salutes with the senior person they are with.
- Juniors enter boats and vehicles first so that seniors may exit first—they may have somewhere important to be afterwards.

“Attention on Deck!”

When a senior officer enters a space occupied only by his/her juniors:

- Come to the position of attention.
- The first person to see the senior enter should call “Attention on Deck” if you are not alone.
- Wait for the senior to instruct you to carry on.

Senior officers wear three or four full stripes, or stars:

- Active duty or reserve CDR, CAPT, and Admirals.
- Auxiliary DCDR or Deputy Department Chief (and some others in special cases).

Calling “Attention on deck” is not usually the custom for Auxiliarists entering a space, regardless of how senior in the organization they may be.

Boarding and Departing a Vessel

When boarding a vessel:

- Turn to face the stern and salute the National ensign (e.g., the U.S. flag) before crossing the brow
- Then salute the officer of the deck and say, “Request permission to come aboard.”

When departing a vessel:

- Salute the officer of the deck and ask “Request permission to leave the ship”.
- Then salute the ensign after you have crossed the brow.



Observe Meal Time Courtesy

Avoid talk of:

- Politics
- Religion
- “Shop” – matters relating to your duties

When in doubt, allow the senior person present to guide conversation.

Remove cover in eating areas, and never lay it on the table.

Avoid sitting at the table until the most senior person at your table is seated.

Do not begin eating until all at the table have been served, nor should you begin until the senior person has begun.

Avoid leaving the table until the senior person has done so.

Courtesy in your Correspondence

Informal (e-mail):

- Begin messages with the proper model of address;
- Complimentary closing to seniors is “Very respectfully,” also abbreviated “v/r,”
- Complimentary closing to juniors can be “Respectfully,” also abbreviated “r/”.

Consult the Coast Guard Correspondence Manual - COMDTINST M5216.4 (Series) for details about formal correspondence (memos, letters, etc.).

U.S. Department of Transportation
United States Coast Guard

Commandant
United States Coast Guard

2100 Second Street, S.W.
Washington, DC 20591-0001
Staff Symbol: G-CM
Phone: (202) 347-4100
Fax: (202) 347-1200
E-Mail: gcm@uscg.mil

5216
1 Jan 2000

Reply to
Attn: el

MEMORANDUM

From: B. Parker-Jones
COMDT (G-CM)

To: CCPC-cpm

Subject: HOW TO PREPARE A MEMORANDUM

Reference: (a) The Coast Guard Correspondence Manual, COMDTINST M5216.3

1. This format replaces the Coast Guard basic letter. The memorandum is for official correspondence within Coast Guard and other departmental operating administrations, Department of Defense units, and other federal agencies. Use names, titles, or staff symbols in the From, To, and Thru lines as local practice dictates.

2. Officials should sign after the name, title or staff symbols that appear in the From line. This eliminates the need for a signature block at the end of the correspondence. Place the number symbol (#) centered two lines below the last paragraph indicating "The End."

3. If you have several addressees, you may submit a Distribution line for the To line. Type Distribution in the To line. Then type Dist: at the left margin on the second line below the enclosure, if any, or the #: Starting two spaces to the right of the colon, list all action addressees. Whether including the addressees in the "To" line or at the end, you may list them either horizontally or vertically, separating them with a semicolon. Examples: CCPC-cpm; HSCG; MSC Galveston; COMDT (G-CM).

4. Be aware when addressing Headquarters memos or using organizational names alone. Some offices located in different districts may have very similar organizational names. Avoid misrouting by using the staff symbol, e.g. (G-CM).

5. Thru addressees may approve without comment by putting their initials and a date in the Thru line. An alternative is to prepare an endorsement as though endorsing a memorandum. See Chapter 4 for further information.

Funeral Services

The family of the deceased governs the extent of Auxiliary participation in funeral services. Any Auxiliarist having knowledge of the death of a fellow Auxiliarist should notify the Flotilla Commander without delay.